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Edited by Diana Davis and Karen Wiens

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My Life Story

Richard Davis

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Foreword

Richard Davis wrote this book at some point, and then we decided to add family photographs and self publish it. Blah blah blah etc.

Diana Davis
Exeter, NH
April 2026

The early years

My parents

That my mother and father got together is probably the first miracle in a life (mine) in which miracles seemed to occur with some regularity. My parents were very different people, from backgrounds that were different in some ways and similar in others. I think I took after my mother and my sister, Edyth, took after our father. That surely contributed to our strengths and weaknesses but turned out to be pretty good overall, I think.



Dick and Edyth with their parents

My father, Robert Davis

My father, Robert (Bob), was the product of a union between his father, John L. Davis, and his father's housekeeper, Susan Weir Poole, who was married to but separated from William Poole at the time.



Susan Weir Poole Davis and William Davis

John¹ was a widower whose wife, Clymena M. Pearce, had died several years earlier, probably in her late twenties or early thirties. I don't know what caused her death but it could have been one of many things, medicine not having been the miracle that it is today.²

Their daughter, Elizabeth, lived with her maternal grandparents in Lyme, NH. I don't think she had much of a

¹born the youngest of 11 children

²William Poole made a beautifully handcrafted box for Clymena, with her initials CMP on top. It stayed in the family but fell into disrepair, with all of the inlaid pieces coming off of the box. Dick Davis restored it and gave it to Diana Davis in the 2010s. Inside the box is Clymena's funeral notice.



John L. Davis; Elizabeth Davis, daughter of John and Clymena

relationship with her father. My father was aware of Elizabeth and met her a few times but I don't think I ever met her. We have pictures of her.

Susan had two daughters with Bill Poole, Marian and Helen, who were older and on their own.

Bob was born in 1907 in Alton. Bob lived with his parents in Alton, NH; John was stationmaster for the Boston and Maine Railroad in Alton Bay.

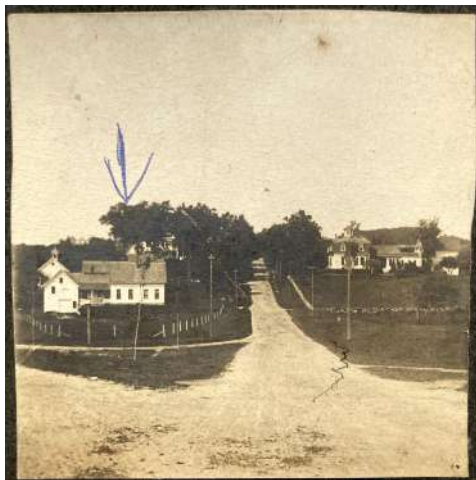
After his retirement from the B&M RR, they moved to his home in Lakeport. John and Susan married a few years later Bob's birth, after her divorce from Bill Poole. A few years after that John and Susan divorced. At that time John owned two houses on Washington Street in Lakeport, just two houses apart, and Susan received one of them in the settlement. They both lived the rest of their lives in those homes but I believe they never again spoke to one another.

After the divorce of his parents my father lived with his mother and saw his father only occasionally.

To support herself and her son my grandmother worked as

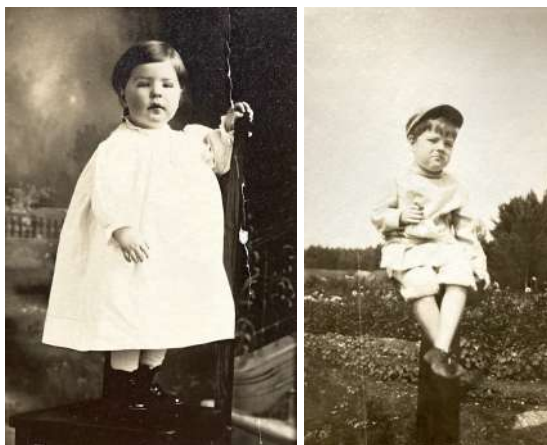


Marian Poole; Helen Poole



The birthplace of Robert Davis

janitor at both Washington Street and Mechanic Street Schools for many years. It involved stoking the coal furnaces, clearing



Robert Davis as a young child

the sidewalks of snow, cleaning the rooms and hallways and probably many other chores. It was her tradition to give a party for teachers when they retired or left the school. My father helped her with clearing snow, shoveling coal and other tasks. He attended Washington Street School and the old Laconia High School on Academy Street. He quit school at the age of 16, after his sophomore year and went to work for his brother-in-law, Fred May, husband of his half-sister, Marian, a printer in Boston.

My mother, Zaida Mack

My mother, Zaida, was born December 28, 1911 in Millinocket, Maine, the second daughter and third child of Robert Barry Mack and Sarah Corkum Mack.

Her siblings were (Charles) Barry who was twelve years older and Marguerite who was two years older.

A few years after my mother's birth, maybe the latter part of that decade, the marriage of her parents, Robert and Sarah, ended. Robert joined the Marine Corps and was stationed



Charles Barry Mack; Ethel Lucy Marguerite Mack; Edyth Zaida Leona Mack

in Panama. Sarah took her two girls, Zaida and Marguerite, probably in their pre-teens, and went to live with her sister, Ida, in Lakeport, NH. Barry was perhaps 18 by then, was on his own and remained in Maine. When Robert returned to Maine with Crohn's Disease, he went to the VA hospital in Bangor where he died in 1923. They never saw him again; the girls thought their father was dead when they left Millinocket.³

Zaida's father Robert Barry Mack was born in Biddeford, ME in 1870 and her mother Sarah Corkum (Mack) in West Berlin, Nova Scotia in 1875. The parents both taught school in West Berlin and Mill Village, Nova Scotia. They married in Boston in 1895 and Barry was born in 1900, probably in Mill Village. In the first decade of the 1900s Robert and Sarah moved from Nova Scotia to Millinocket, ME where Robert found employment in the Great Northern Paper Company which had recently opened. Millinocket became a small, successful rural town, mostly due to the paper industry, but also due to its

³We learned this very late in life. Sometime in the 1990s, Dick, Carol, Diana and Marguerite traveled to Millinocket to find Marguerite's father's grave. We searched in both cemeteries for his death year but did not find him. We returned another day and opened the search to other years. Marguerite, in her late 80s, was shocked to learn that her father had lived *four years* longer than she had believed.

proximity to Mount Katahdin, Maine's tallest mountain, and Moosehead Lake, Maine's largest lake.



Robert Barry Mack in his Marine Corps uniform; Sarah Corkum Mack with Dick in 1956

Mother often mentioned the majesty of Mount Katahdin looming over her home town. She remembered, as a young girl, the times she and her sister, Marguerite, walked to the mill to bring their father's lunch to him. She also remembered large horse drawn sleds coming down from Katahdin in the winter bringing logs from the mountain to the paper mill. Children would hang onto the sides of the big sleds and slide along on their feet, a great sport at the time.

From Lakeport Sarah and the girls moved to Laconia, a few miles away, and lived in a small apartment in the Colonial Theater building, above the theater. Sarah made a living as a seamstress and selling corsets, but times were very lean. They often didn't have enough to eat and the apartment had only two rooms, one of which was a work space and place to meet customers. I think they had just a hot plate for cooking. They

may have shared a bathroom with people in other apartments. The three had to make do with very little but they made it.

Both girls graduated from Laconia High School and my mother Zaida took a post graduate year in business, learning typing, shorthand and book keeping. She went to work as a secretary at a large furniture store and Marguerite worked in a jewelry store in Laconia. At that point they were able to contribute to the support of themselves and their mother. They still lived together in the Colonial Theater building.



The cast of a performance on the *Mount Washington* boat on Lake Winnepesaukee in 1936. Robert, Zaida and Marguerite are together in the center of the picture, Robert with a top hat, Zaida with a parasol and Marguerite with a fabulous scarf.

By their mid-20s the girls were more than ready to move out of their mother's apartment and make a life for themselves. My mother never spoke of having had boyfriends in high school

and after. At some point she met Robert Davis (my father). I don't know under what circumstances they met. I know he had a motorcycle and they went for rides. On one ride my father misjudged a turn and went off the road. He went over the handlebars and cut his lip on a metal bracket on the front fender; her leg ended up under the rear sprocket and cut into her kneecap. She never got on a motorcycle again, and they both had scars for the rest of their lives. She said in later years that what most attracted her to him was that his parents each owned a house.

My childhood in Lakeport

My parents married in 1937; my mother was 25 and my father was 30.



My parents' wedding announcement

I was born about a year later, and my sister, Edyth, was born two and a half years after that. My mother was a stay at home mom while we were young. She took us to Opechee Park nearly every day in the summer. Opechee Park had a beautiful sandy beach with clean, clear water that we enjoyed playing in. We lived in an apartment building in Laconia. One of the reasons we went to the beach often may have been that the house had a flat roof, no air conditioning and probably not much insulation, so it was really hot in the summer. An expression of the time was that if you dropped an egg on the upstairs floor it would fry.



Zaida and Richard swimming in Lake Winnepesaukee

My father made a good middle class wage working for the Laconia Evening Citizen, the city's only newspaper. So my mother didn't have to work and devoted most of her time and effort to raising Edy and me.



Richard is in front of Santa; Edyth is on the right, holding a doll.

We often visited my grandmother, Sarah, who was still living in her apartment in the Colonial Theater building, and Marguerite and her family who also lived in Laconia on Court Street. Marguerite worked full time while my mother didn't work outside the home. Marguerite had her own home and we still lived in an apartment.



Marguerite (left) with a group of children including Richard (front, holding rabbit) and Edyth (front right).

Grandmother Sarah had four grandchildren, three girls and me. While I didn't realize it at the time, I was her favorite because I was a boy and she had lost her son, Barry. Joyce and Peggy have never forgiven her for the favoritism even forty plus years after her death.

My grandfather, John L. Davis, lived alone in his home in Lakeport for many years. We visited him from time to time but not very often. In his later years he developed gangrene in his feet and legs, first one leg and then the other. He ended up having both legs amputated and was unable to live alone. He invited my family to move in with him; my parents agreed. So in 1947 we moved from our five room apartment in Laconia to a ten room Victorian style house at 81 Washington Street in



Richard with Peggy and Joyce

Lakeport. My mother was delighted to be living in a ten room house; this was one of her dreams fulfilled. She proved to be an excellent caregiver to my grandfather.

Grandpa lived for about three years after we moved in with him; he died in 1950 at the age of 79. In his will my grandfather left his home to my parents, my sister and me in equal shares. His rationale may have been to keep the family together or perhaps in appreciation for my mother's care or for making him a part of our family.

John L. Davis and the Lakeport Fire of 1905

We were talking and thinking the other day about fire in the woods around the cottage and it brought to mind the story of my grandfather during the Lakeport fire of 1905 or thereabouts. The Lakeport fire was way out of control and consumed nearly every house on our side of the tracks. Perhaps the major reason it could not be brought under control was that there was no water pressure, so no water was available to douse fires as they



Bob Davis (Richard's father) and his mother Susan in front of their house at 81 Washington Street in Lakeport

spread from house to house.

My grandfather kept a barrel of cider in the house, and when a hot ember landed on his house he doused it with cider. I guess he was able to get up on the roof or wherever the embers landed and put the fire out using a bucket of cider.

That got us to thinking about putting out a fire here in Deer Isle if one should start from the fireplace or elsewhere.

We had a campfire the other evening and put on some dry tinder to make the fire brighter. It also sent some embers up and they landed outside the fireplace. It appeared that they had all cooled and gone out when we finished the campfire and doused the fire in the fireplace.

In the morning we smelled an unusual odor. We looked all around, inside and outside the cabin, and finally found a smoldering fire beside the fireplace where we store kindling and fuel for fires. Thankfully it was contained by rocks, and there wasn't much flammable material to burn. I had recently cleaned



John L. Davis tending to his bees. He moved around by sliding on a board.

up most of the brush that had accumulated there over time. We used a bucket of water from one of our rain barrels to fully douse the fire. That's what brought to mind the similarity between the Lakeport fire and our Deer Isle fire.

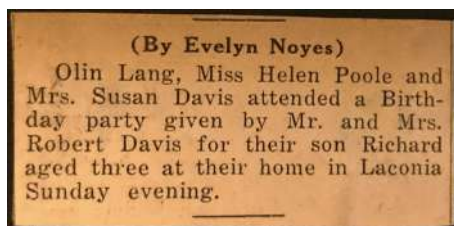
We won't be using dry tinder to make the campfire brighter in the future. We were lucky or someone was looking after us this time; we dodged a bullet that could have set the woods on fire. We could have had the Deer Isle fire of 2016, an unfortunate repeat of a lesson we should have learned by now.

My sister was in first grade and I was in third grade when we moved from Harvard Street School in Laconia to Washington Street School in Lakeport. It was hard moving from one school to another, losing friends we had made in Laconia. My best friend was Dallas (Sonny) Gilson who lived across the street from us and was in my class. Other than Sonny, I remember mostly the girls who were in my class, girls I would meet up with again in Junior High School: Dorothy (Dotty) Chandler, Dianne Pitman, Cecily Ballou, Helen King and others.

We walked to and from Harvard Street School, about a half mile from our home. On the way home for a time I was bullied by the big brother of a classmate, Roger Ladd, who lived on a street we walked to get home. He never did anything physical but it was unpleasant walking by their house. That ended when we moved to Lakeport.

Since the school in Lakeport was across the street from our new home we went home for lunch. We were the second generation to attend Washington Street School; our father also attended. My children, Scott and Karen, were the third generation of our family to attend Washington Street School. Lakeport was much more compact than Laconia and I was able to explore all the streets on our side of the tracks on my bicycle.

I got to know a whole new classroom of students in Lakeport some of whom were bussed from Laconia and Sanbornton to Washington Street. I went to school with these students from third grade all the way through high school. I have a picture of my third grade class and can still name most of the people in the picture. Brian Knight from Sanbornton was in the class and later was in the high school band with me, playing trombone.



The school band

During 6th grade I rode my bicycle to the high school to take cornet lessons which were provided free to local students. I carried the cornet in the wire basket on the front of my bike which I also used to carry newspapers on my morning route. The cornet belonged to my Uncle Barry, my mother's older brother, whom I never met; he died before I was born. My parents sent the instrument to Boston to be reconditioned before I started the lessons. It was a nice, silver instrument but was very hard to play. It took a lot of wind to get sounds out of it. I continued the lessons through junior high school. They were the only music lessons I ever took but they provided a basis for all of my musical endeavors. What I didn't learn from the lessons, I figured out on my own. No problem.

Being in the Laconia High School Band was one of my more significant achievements in high school. I was in the band for the whole four years. In my junior year I was band manager, which mostly consisted of setting up chairs for band practice twice a week. I got to the music room before school started in the morning and set up chairs for practice in the afternoon, last period. My friend, Warren Gifford, helped me set up chairs. He was not in the band but we lived near one another in Lakeport, and got to school at the same time. In my senior year I was elected Captain of the Band. That was about the only office I was ever elected to. I think it was mostly because I had been band manager and my effort in setting up the chairs for the band rehearsal during the previous year.



Marching band uniform

I started off playing cornet as a freshman, probably as fourth chair which is the least capable player in the section. Our band leader was Bernard Williams, the teacher of all things musical in the high school; music history, chorus, double quartet, band and more. He was a graduate of Michigan State University. I thought he was older but he was probably only 30, maybe younger. While I was in the band he and his wife had a baby girl and, during a rehearsal, we all sang, My Blue Heaven, “Just Molly and me and baby makes three, we’re happy in my blue heaven.”

In my sophomore year he needed a tuba player. The high school owned two tubas and when one player graduated another was needed. I was a good candidate since tuba music is generally less challenging than that of the cornet/trumpet. The instruments were double B Flat tubas. The music for tuba is written in the bass clef whereas music for cornet is in the treble clef, so I had to figure that out. No problem.

Amazingly, during my senior year Mr. Williams nominated me for All State Band, usually in recognition for outstanding



Playing the tuba in school

performance in your chosen instrument. Maybe it's also for leadership and contributions to the good of the band. After three years playing the tuba I was reasonably competent but surely not outstanding. I had to audition for the part and I did not do well. The person who auditioned me was the wife of the assistant band leader in the 281st Army Band,; i.e. the (NGB) National Guard Band in which I also played. But I was selected; it must have been based on leadership as well as on music. Mr. Williams once said of me, "It's amazing how someone with so little knowledge can go so far". I agree. Maybe someone "up

there” was looking after me.



Playing the tuba at the National Guard camp

In our junior year my classmate Don Champaign joined the band as a tuba player. He was a football player, class clown and a member of the NGB in Laconia. The manager of the NGB came to our high school band rehearsal one afternoon to recruit players for his band. He said that there would be no conflict between the bands; the high school band would take preference during parades and such. So I signed up. Minimum age was 18 and I was 17 but the manager put age 18 on the paperwork and I was in. I never heard about the matter again. It turned out that my time in the Guard counted for time served for pay purposes in the Navy.

In the summer of 1955 we went to National Guard camp for two weeks at Camp Edwards on Cape Cod. We rode in the back of an Army truck, a canvass covered utility truck, all the way to the Cape. We lined up for meals in the chow line. We practiced our instruments and our musical selections. We gave a concert for the enjoyment of the rest of the Guardsmen. I don't remember peeling potatoes nor washing dishes; I think the Band was excused from those duties. We didn't fire weapons at the

range either; we didn't have weapons, just instruments. We had liberty, time off in the evening, to go to Barnstable for a few hours. The whole time was a positive and fun experience.



At the National Guard camp

I was nominated for Guardsman of the Year from the Band, one of three from the Laconia Guard units. I'm sure it was based on my appointment to the Naval Academy or that nobody else in the band wanted it. I had to go before a senior Officer and answer some questions. When I walked in the door for the interview I was supposed to salute the Officer. I didn't know that and I didn't do it. I was not selected as Guardsman of the Year. Somebody more deserving was, which showed me, at least, that it was based on merit, not politics.

High school

After sixth grade at Washington Street School we went to the seventh grade at the combined Laconia junior high and high school, a couple of miles from home. Things were different. We had different teachers for different classes and a different room for each class. We had students from several different elementary schools in Laconia including the Catholic school as well as Lakeport, Gilford and Sanbornton, all merging into one school. We went from a class of twenty or so to a class of 160. There were lots of new kids to get to know. There were also kids I knew from Harvard Street School where I attended K through 2nd grade before moving to Lakeport.

A few things stand out about my academic experience. I took Latin my freshman year and hated it. At mid-year I dropped the course which made me a course short at the end of the year. To make up for that I took a course in mechanical drawing, in addition to the four required courses. I also took Spanish since two years of a language were required for the college prep curriculum. I found Spanish almost as difficult as Latin but there was no turning back now. I learned a lesson which was valuable for life; once you start something, finish it; the alternative may be just as tough as or tougher than staying the original course. Taking Spanish turned out to be a good decision since I was able to continue studying Spanish at the Naval Academy. I should have made the right decision the first time. At the time I thought I was a smart kid, and I thought all smart kids took Latin. That turned out to be not so smart.

Another thing that stands out about my academic experience was my geometry course. I was taking it my junior year; the Civil Service exam for the service academies covered geometry and was in the spring before I completed the course. So I worked with my teacher to accelerate and complete the course before taking the Civil Service exam. I did that and she gave me the final exam. Initially she told me I didn't do well on the test but somehow she had erred; on rechecking she found I had done well. I went into the civil Service exam with confidence and got high marks, which helped when it was time to go for an appointment to a service academy.

I didn't do much dating in High School. As I look back on it I could have dated a number of classmates who were in the band and in many of my classes, including Jeananne Curtis, Judy Simonds, Mary Sattan, Dianne Pitman, Dotty Chandler and probably several others. As a result of my timidity or lack of interest and that of many of my classmates, we didn't do much dating in high school. If I only knew then what I know now, life might have been different. On the other hand, things turned out pretty well overall.

My first girlfriend was Janet Stafford who was two years behind me in school, in my sister's class. My mother knew her parents from church, and she arranged our first date. I think dating was a new experience for both of us. At the time dating meant going places together, like school dances, and maybe holding hands. Sex was not a factor in my crowd, although one or more girls in my class got pregnant. Janet was my date for the Senior Prom and she came down to the Naval Academy with my parents for Parent's Weekend after completion of Plebe Summer. We corresponded during the year but broke up near the end of Plebe Year.

The breakup was unfair to her. She was a junior in high school and went to dances and other activities with kids in her class. That should have been expected and a normal thing for her to do. At some activity my sister saw her having fun, probably innocent fun, with a guy in her class and reported it to me. I promptly ended the relationship. She had actually

purchased a dress to wear at a dance at the Naval Academy. I still feel badly about that whole episode. Janet ended up marrying a friend of mine and they were still married the last I knew. So maybe it was fortunate for her that I ended the relationship, but it was hard for her at the time.

I had a paper route from the fifth grade to the ninth grade. I delivered four different morning newspapers, The Boston Post, The Boston Herald, the Boston Record and the Manchester Union Leader. I had about sixty papers to deliver each weekday morning before school and on Saturday, and about 100 papers on Sunday. I covered most of Lakeport on our side of the tracks. My father always drove me around the route in the car on Sunday when I couldn't readily carry 100 Sunday papers in my bicycle in good weather or in a sled in the winter. We stacked them across the rear seat of the car in four piles. I collected money from my customers on Saturday or Sunday and he helped me keep track of who paid and who didn't, with a little ledger book.

I made about seven dollars a week for 51 weeks and about \$100 at Christmas on the paper route. This adds up to about \$450 a year which was quite a lot of money in the 1950s for a school kid. I saved most of the money; my parents didn't charge me room & board and I never contributed to the cost of gas for the car. Gas was really cheap at that time, and so was I. With money I saved I was able to buy several things I would otherwise not have been able to afford, like a new Schwinn bicycle with spring fork, chrome fenders and chrome tank, a ski boat, and a 1941 Chevrolet two door coupe.

I bought the car in 1953 at age 15, before I was old enough to drive. I found it in a pasture in Gilford, paid \$50 for it, and we got it home somehow; I'm sure it wouldn't run. My father and Ben Schreiber, a family friend, spent quite a bit of time and money getting the car running and in drivable condition. They probably put in new piston rings, overhauled the carburetor and perhaps replaced other things like brakes, exhaust system and the like. By the time I was 16 I had a usable car. I used it to go to school and back, and transported my sister and her

friend, Joan Levesque, to and from school as well. I drove to school functions and to places not too far from home. I had no insurance on the car so I was careful how I used it and where I went with it.

Another major influence during my last year of high school and beyond was my boat. At the end of junior year our class of 1956 had a party for our classmate, Dottie Chandler, who was going to attend Goucher College in Towson, MD. She had been accepted at Goucher after completion of her junior year. The party was held at Dianne Pitman's camp on Lake Winnepesaukee, and someone had a ski boat, probably Dick Perley. In any case, I got to water ski for the first time in my life. I was hooked. This was the most fun I had ever had up to that time. I had to have a boat.



Richard and Edyth with the boat

I purchased the boat from Irwin Marine in my home town, Lakeport. It was a 14' Chris-Craft kit boat made mostly of plywood. I built it in our garage with a lot of help from my father and Ben Schreiber. Many more details of the construction

and early use of the boat are in another section of the book called, "Boats I Have Owned, Part I". I bought the kit with money I had saved from my paper route.

When I was in high school my father bought a new red Harley Davidson motorcycle. On weekends, we used to ride the motorcycle to various parts of NH with like-minded friends. While I don't remember our riding with him, Cliff Mitchell also had a motorcycle, in his case an Indian motorcycle. Cliff's son, Warren, dated Janet after I broke up our relationship, and he married her. He ended up running the Stafford Oil Company in Laconia and Alton. That worked out well all the way around I suspect.

On one occasion when he was away and the motorcycle was in the shed on the side of the garage, I took it for a ride with my friend Duane Schreiber on behind. We went up the Weirs Boulevard and I misjudged the first turn, swerving way over to the left side of the road. If there had been a car coming toward us we might well have had a head-on collision. This was the first occasion when I felt that someone with higher powers was looking after me. Maybe at the time I attributed it to good luck but after a number of "lucky breaks" I decided it was a higher power. Back when my parents were dating my father misjudged a curve on his motorcycle with my mother on behind, went off the road and dumped the cycle, he was not as lucky as I was or didn't have someone looking after him. Or maybe he was not as lucky as I was.

When I was a junior in high school my mother worked as a volunteer on the campaign for the US Senate of a former Governor of NH, Wesley Powell. Governor Powell lost the Senate election but, in the process of working with him, my mother established a connection that was valuable in my getting appointed to the Naval Academy. We met privately with Governor Powell at his home in Hampton, and he told me what I needed to do to get a political appointment. Basically I had to ask several politicians in Laconia as well as the principal of my high school to write letters of recommendation to our two US Senators and the representative from our district. They

did that and I got a principal appointment. I also wrote letters and met with one of our Senators who had visiting hours in Laconia. He was the one who appointed me, Senator Norris Cotton.

Senator Cotton had awarded his appointments to the Military Academy and the Naval Academy to other candidates but I must have impressed him or maybe the letters convinced him that I was a good candidate. So he found an appointment to the Naval Academy from another Senator and gave it to me. This is the second major occurrence in which a higher power interceded in my behalf, and sent me to the Naval Academy rather than West Point. Annapolis was surely a better fit than West Point would have been, and I spent the period of the Vietnam War on a ship and in Washington DC rather than in the jungle or on a river getting shot at.

Senior year in high school I was concentrating on getting into college in addition to other school activities. I applied to all the service academies but was most interested in West Point at the time. It was the only one we had visited and it was closest to home. One day in the spring of my senior year the headlines of the Laconia Evening Citizen proclaimed "Stafford and Davis Appointed to the Naval Academy". George Stafford was appointed by Styles Bridges, Senior Senator from NH and I was appointed by Senator Cotton. Both Senators were Republicans as were a majority of the citizens of NH, including my father. The Stafford family was well connected in NH state politics and they were able to get the appointment for George. Unfortunately George did not pass the entrance exam and did not attend the Academy. He was the cousin of my first girlfriend, Janet.

I was aware that if I didn't get into a service academy I would likely go to UNH, and to go to UNH I would need financial aid. It occurred to me that people might think that a kid who owned a car, even a 1941 Chevy, might not need or be the best candidate for a scholarship. So I sold the car, put the money in my college fund and walked or bicycled to school and other activities during senior year.

I graduated from high school on June 25, 1956 standing in the top 10% of my class of 160 students. We marched to graduation two by two, a girl and a boy side by side. I asked Mary Sattan to march with me and she did. We never dated but we were in the band and a small dance band together. She lived across the street from Janet Stafford. She was Valedictorian of our class and went to MIT. She received a trophy for her academic achievements and I received two, one for being all around good guy, I guess and I don't remember what the other was for. My trophy was in honor of an earlier graduate given by his parents. I remember going to visit his mother to thank her for the honor. The trophy was awarded every year at graduation so it was not something I got to keep.

From the time we graduated until I needed to leave to report to the Naval Academy I spent time in my boat on Lake Winnepesaukee. I knew the lake well and enjoyed going to Marguerite's camp on Moultonboro Second Neck which took about an hour at planning speed of 20 mph or so. We water skied and tooled around visiting the various harbors on the lake, like Wolfeboro and Center Harbor where the excursion vessel MV Mount Washington was pulled out of the water for the winter and a stop on its excursions around the lake.

Mental Illness in My Family I

I first became aware of a problem when my mother pulled my father out of the garage in Lakeport as Edy and I were leaving in our band uniforms for a Saturday afternoon high school football game. The car had been running in the closed garage and my father was unconscious with carbon monoxide poisoning.

Dad was taken to the Laconia Hospital and later transferred to the New Hampshire State Hospital in Concord. He recovered from the carbon monoxide poisoning but it was determined that he had suffered a mental breakdown. He had shock treatments and other therapies over the course of several months. I guess attempted suicide was considered a mental breakdown at the



Edy in her band uniform

time (1950s); I wonder if it is today. He must have been unable to cope with life so decided to end it all. This may not have been a rational decision but I question whether it was mental illness?

Mother insisted that Edy and I go to the football game

as planned, which we did. We continued our regular routines during the time Dad was in the state hospital. I felt badly that my father would attempt suicide and end up in the state hospital, but happy that he was going to be okay. I didn't feel that I was in any way responsible for his actions, but that may not be true. More about that later. We visited him on weekends when we could. I don't know who among our friends and neighbors knew about Dad's situation, but it did not seem to affect our relationships with our friends. We were upset that Dad was in the State Hospital but we were able to attend school and pursue sports and other activities as before.

How we managed financially I don't know. Dad's employer, the Laconia Evening Citizen newspaper, must have continued to pay his salary or some part of it during the time he was out of work. Or maybe there was some government aid program I wasn't aware of. In any case we lived pretty much as we had when Dad was working and bringing in a paycheck.

A few years later, when I was a sophomore at the Naval Academy, my father was again admitted to the State Hospital. I don't remember what caused that admission; he may have admitted himself. I remember that, when I was home on leave, I visited the hospital in my Midshipman uniform and inquired into his situation. That was supposed to impress the hospital officials, I guess; I'm not sure it did. Anyway, a while after that he was released from the Hospital.

My parents' divorce

A couple of years later my parents divorced. It should have happened years before that but I selfishly insisted that they stay together so that I could grow up in a "normal" family. What did I know about marital relations and the pressures they were under? Nothing. It was all about me. In hindsight it was very selfish on my part; I had no idea what was really going on in the marriage. I just didn't want to have my family broken up. After I had been away at school for a while my mother filed for

divorce and my father moved out or perhaps was thrown out. It was final in 1958, the year my sister graduated from high school. That's not the whole story but I will save that chapter for another time.



Family pictures in front of the house

My father moved in with his widowed half-sister, Aunt Helen, in her house in Winnisquam. He continued working for the Citizen newspaper, probably paid some alimony for a while and gave my mother use of the house while she was alive. He ended up losing his family homestead (his father's house) forever as it turned out. I had a part in that also. I really had positive feelings for my father but I did some things that I am not pleased about in hindsight. I guess I was first my mother's boy although I didn't think so at the time. That's another part of the story for another time.

Aunt Helen got sick and passed away not long after my father moved in with her, and left her home to him. She was several years older than he was. While I was attending Submarine School in 1962, at home for the weekend, Sue Lindsey and I wallpapered his bathroom to make the place a little more livable.

He continued living there for a few years but ultimately sold it to a developer who demolished it.

As a single man in his early sixties my father spent some time at the Rod & Gun Club in Laconia. It was a drinking club with dances on the weekends. He met Delia DuPont there, ultimately married her and moved into her mobile home. When my father retired at age 65 in 1972, they sold the mobile home, bought a house in Tilton Northfield and lived there, somewhat contentedly, for many years.

In any case, after the divorce from my mother, Dad was able to live a “normal” life, free from any more “mental illness.” I’ve been aware of the “mental illness” in my family, wondering when it was going to hit Edy and me. So far, so good. In Dad’s case, at least, this was depression and hopelessness. Actually, depression and hopelessness is a form of mental illness. I guess that is not hereditary.

Doug Watts

Doug was my best friend during my first three years of high school. He was a year older than I and a year ahead of me in school so he graduated a year earlier. He lived on North Street in Lakeport, a few blocks from my home on Washington Street. I don't know why we didn't become friends in elementary school or junior high, as we both attended the same schools, but we had three great years after that.

Doug had two sisters and a brother, all older than him and all out on their own. So he was essentially an only child while growing up. While it never occurred to me at the time, I guess he may have been a surprise to his parents. His parents were older than most parents of children our age. In any case we were great friends and that lasted for many years after high school.

During the school year we were both in the Laconia High School Band. He started out on clarinet and moved to bass clarinet. I started on cornet and moved on to the tuba. I guess we weren't great musicians but we were reliable and worked at playing our instruments well. We played in the marching band for football games and parades, and in the concert band during the rest of the school year. In the summer we brought our instruments home and had our own little practice sessions, usually in my home. It's amazing how much I improved over the summer, so when I returned to school in the fall, my playing was substantially better. During my sophomore and junior years I set up chairs a couple of mornings a week, for band rehearsal last period in the afternoon. In my senior year I was elected



Captain of the band, the only thing I was ever elected to in school, mostly because I set up the chairs, I think.

In the spring we both went out for track. Doug threw the shot put and discus. I ran the 100 and 220 yard dashes, and the 400 and 880 yard relays. Irwin Smith was the track and cross country coach, and the only Spanish teacher in the high school. I took two years of Spanish and I think Doug did as well. We never conversed in Spanish. I guess our track talents somewhat paralleled our musical talents: we were reliable and we worked

at our events, and we did receive letters for our efforts.



Ribbons from high school track

We were Sea Scouts in the Lakeport Sea Scout Ship 147. Our Scout Master was Roland Dion who took great interest in all the Scouts. The Ship was sponsored by the Lakeport Baptist Church, although we met in a vacant storefront in downtown Lakeport. There were several young men in Sea Scouts, some a year or two ahead of us in school. After the meetings we often piled into Don Flander's father's Cadillac and went bowling. Another member was Jack Wilkins who played the baritone horn in the high school band and, after graduation, joined the Navy and played in the Navy Band. At that time I had little or no interest in the Navy. Looking back on it I think we were more of a boy's club in Sea Scout uniforms than an active Sea Scout Ship.

The Sea Scouts were recipients of an old wooden sailboat on Lake Winnepesaukee. None of us knew much of anything about sailing nor about taking care of an old wooden sailboat. We tied the boat to a public dock during the summer and left it there for the winter. Doug and I visited it from time to time but after a winter in the ice there was not much left of the boat. Doug had



Scouting group

a goal of making Eagle Scout, and he did. I didn't have that as a goal and I only got as far as Life Scout, one fairly large step below Eagle.



Scouting activities

My mother bought me a government surplus rubber boat, when I was 15 or younger. Doug and I decided to take the rubber boat up Paugus Bay a short way and camp out for the night in the woods alongside the Bay. I think it must have been a one man boat because, with two of us in it, it was very difficult to make it move. The inflatable tube was much larger in the stern than in the bow. I think the one person was supposed to sit in the stern, stretching out legs toward the bow. Doug

ended up lying on his back in the bow of the boat, doing the back stroke to help propel the boat forward. Doug was always a little heavy so that compounded the situation. Water came over the bow, soaking everything we had in the boat. After a mile or so and went ashore at a little beach area. I don't remember camping out; we probably rested, had lunch and returned home.



Dick (left) with Doug (right) in Dick's boat

Later I purchased a very much used canvas covered canoe which we paddled around Lake Winnepesaukee. Since he was heavier, Doug sat in the stern and I was in the bow. The stern person steers the boat and has a mechanical advantage over the

bow person, especially when he's heavier. The stern becomes a pivot point around which the boat moves. It seemed like I had to work twice as hard to keep the boat going straight. If I knew then what I know now, I would have just paddled and let him steer the boat.

Doug and I were both very reserved (shy) when it came to girls. I don't remember him ever dating in high school. I don't think he probably dated much if any in college. He was overweight his whole life, not greatly but somewhat. So he was pretty much a clean slate with respect to girls. I wasn't quite as reserved as that and gradually became more confident after high school.



Hiking with Doug

After graduation from high school Doug went to UNH where he studied biology. He graduated and later earned a Masters Degree at the University of Maryland. When I was a senior at the Naval Academy, Doug visited and joined us for the evening



Hiking with Doug (right) and another friend

meal. He was “best man” in my wedding in 1963. I don’t remember what he was doing at that time, working or going to school. Our career paths went in totally different directions but they crossed every now and then, mostly thanks to Doug’s initiative and the fact that we returned to NH in 1969 and, occasionally, he came home to visit.

He went into the Peace Corps and was sent to “Palau, an island country in the western Pacific Ocean. The country’s population of around 21,000 is spread across 250 islands, which form the western chain of the Caroline Islands in Micronesia. Palau is a presidential republic in free association with the United States, which provides defense, funding, and access to social services.”⁴ This must be why they sent Doug to Palau.

I don’t know what Doug did for the Peace Corps in Palau;

⁴from Wikipedia

today most Peace Corps volunteers in Palau teach ESL, but I do know that he had a native girl, Liz, as a housekeeper. He was there for three years and, when he returned to the US, Liz was his wife. I think that Liz was the first and only female he was ever seriously involved with. She was very intelligent, adapted to the US quickly and became a skilled tennis player. They had a son and a daughter, and adopted Liz's younger sister. The children were beautiful. The son went to the Naval Academy but left after a short time. It was not a good match for him.

Doug got a job with the US Coast and Geodetic Survey and worked on ships mapping and charting the oceans around the world. He worked out of Gulf Port, MS where they had a home. Doug was away for months at a time and Liz had responsibility for the family and home while he was gone. It must have been difficult, coming from Palau, to manage a household in the US. She was fluent in English but surely unfamiliar with many aspects of life in the US. After being at sea for an extended period Doug got some time off to reconnect with his family. They returned to Palau from time to time to visit with Liz's parents, other family and friends there.

They visited us in Madbury a few times. They had a small motor home which they used for long trips. On one occasion they brought a cooler filled with shrimp, frozen in ice. We thought they were bringing it for dinner and attempted to thaw, cook and serve the shrimp. It didn't turn out well; it was intended as a gift for future use. But it was a nice gift and a nice gesture.

A few years ago I was notified that Doug had passed away a couple of years earlier. I think he had a heart attack at a relatively young age, maybe 65, likely a result of his having been overweight his whole life. Doug made an effort to stay in touch with me and for that I am thankful. Doug was an intelligent and capable guy. I learned a lot from him. I really hope he had a wonderful life and that Liz and his children are doing well from having been his family. It would be great if someday we could meet again, either in this life or the next. I was blessed to have been a part of his life.

The Naval Academy

Plebe Summer at the US Naval Academy

This phase of my life began on the morning of June 7, 1956 when my parents dropped me off in Annapolis, MD, having driven from our home in NH and spent the night in a motel a few miles out of town. I was one of around 1,100 young men of the Class of 1960 beginning a four year course of education and training leading to a Bachelors Degree in Naval Science and a commission as an Ensign in the Navy or a 2nd Lieutenant in the Marine Corps. I knew no one and was a little overwhelmed at the idea of being at the Naval Academy.

The first thing I remember doing, after being issued a large laundry bag, is filling it with clothing: several sets of white works (working sailor outfits), Dixie cup caps with a blue band around the top to distinguish us from enlisted sailors, neckerchiefs, shoes, black, brown and athletic, underwear, handkerchiefs, every article of clothing we would need for the next four years, other than dress uniforms. The civilian clothes we wore that day we placed in a cardboard box to be sent home. We would not need them for at least three years, probably never again. We were soon to be in the Navy.

We were assigned to companies for the summer training and indoctrination, and to rooms in Bancroft Hall, the largest dormitory in the world. When I was there Bancroft Hall had six wings, four stories high, each wing large enough to house 650 midshipmen. Since then two additional wings have been added,



With his Dixie cup cap, and some of the Naval Academy sailboats

not for additional students but for better accommodations. When we arrived at our assigned rooms we found out who our roommates were.

I was assigned a room with three other young men, Frank Shotton from Virginia, Gerry Taylor from Maryland and John Schmidt from Peoria, Illinois. After Plebe summer we went into academic year companies where we would remain for the next four years. John Schmidt and I chose to continue as roommates. The other two went on to other companies. Four years later we all graduated with the Class of 1960.



John Schmidt and Bancroft Hall, 1956

The next thing we needed was a haircut, not just any haircut but a Plebe haircut. A Plebe is a freshman at a military academy, and is distinguishable from upper classmen in many ways including close cut hair. The barbers simply use electric clippers to cut our hair to a uniformly close cropped cut. It doesn't take long before we all have the same short hair.

Midshipmen march in formation to every meal. In good weather we form into ranks on decks outside of Bancroft Hall; in bad weather we form up inside Bancroft. During Plebe summer midshipmen are selected to be officers to direct the platoons and companies of their classmates to their destinations, under the direction of upper class midshipmen. I was selected to be a platoon commander. In addition, a commissioned officer is assigned to each company, usually a newly graduated ensign or 2nd LT from the Class of 1956. Our Company Officer was Ensign Robert Shumacher, who retired some 30 years later as Rear Admiral Robert Shumacher and selection as a Distinguished Graduate of the Naval Academy.



With John Schmidt in front of Bancroft Hall, 1956

At mealtime we march to King Hall, named in honor of Fleet Admiral Ernest King, the mess (dining) hall which is attached to Bancroft Hall at the back. It accommodates all 4000 midshipmen at the same time. In the summer just a portion of the mess hall is used for the 1100 Plebes.

At some point during that first day, June 7, 1956, now known as "T" Day or Induction Day, we all took the oath of office, pledging our loyalty to our country and our intention to carry out our duties faithfully and to the best of our abilities. We were now officially in the Navy. My date of service starts on that date which is how I was able to retire in 1986 with 30 years of service.



Dick, and Edy and Zaida, during Induction Day family activities

Most young men entering the Naval Academy are right out of high school, as I was. Others came from active duty as enlisted men in the Navy or Marine Corps and some had a year or two of college. Most former enlisted Sailors and Marines attended NAPS, the Naval Academy Prep School in Newport, RI, and a few entered from other prep schools. NAPS provided the academic review and preparation to assure that men who had been away from books for some time were able to be successful with the rigorous academics at the Academy. Most former enlisted sailors and marines graduated and went on to successful careers as officers in the Navy. A few became Admirals. It was in 1980 that women first attended the Academy, twenty years after I graduated. It was tough for women in the first years they attended the Academy. Some upper class midshipmen felt they didn't belong there in spite of the fact that Congress authorized it. So women had to work harder and be smarter just to remain at the Academy.

It is important that a Naval Officer be impeccably attired in his dress uniform including shined shoes. The black and brown shoes we were issued were of high quality but they did not come with a proper shine on the toe. It was up to each Plebe to bring the toe of each shoe to a high gloss. This was accomplished by a process known as spit shining. Former enlisted sailors and marines taught the rest of us the fine art of spit shining, and we spent many hours that first summer spit shining our shoes.

The purpose of Plebe summer is to accomplish the transition

of the new Plebes from civilian to Navy midshipman, like boot camp for sailors and marines. We marched in formation from Bancroft Hall to the Parade field and practiced our marching routines under the eye of a Marine Captain, a graduate of the Academy. It was hot and humid in Maryland during July and August so we marched and drilled in the morning. We also learned to use 45 caliber hand guns and M1 rifles under the instruction of sailors and marines; some of us qualified for expert pistol and rifle badges. We learned to sail, we learned to row whale boats, we ran the obstacle course, we took swimming tests, we studied Naval History and tradition. We became a cohesive group of men proud to be in the Class of 1960.

My Life as a Plebe at the US Naval Academy

Plebe summer ends with the return of the upper classmen from cruise and four weeks of leave. This signals the start of the academic year. When I was there, each midshipman took the same course of instruction, the same subjects except there was a choice of several different languages, including Spanish, German, Russian, French and Italian. Companies were formed on the basis of languages. My company was comprised of Spanish learners. In our last year or two we were able to take a few elective courses but we all graduated with a BS in Naval Science. Today there are many different majors in engineering, science and the humanities.

My Plebe summer roommate, John Schmidt and I chose to room together during the academic year. We were assigned to a four man room with Jay Broach and Roger Hamm. Jay's father was a graduate of the Naval Academy and had been a submarine captain; he was deceased and buried in the Naval Academy Cemetery. Roger's father was a Navy Chief Petty Officer. John's father and mine had not served in the military; we were the first in our immediate families to serve.

Jay Broach was able to make his life as a Plebe different from that of most of us. On some afternoons after class he would go into town (which was strictly prohibited for Plebes), meet a girl and have sex somewhere out there, and get back in time for evening meal. How he managed that I have no idea.

The Academy is enclosed in a high wall which Midshipmen sometimes climbed at night but never during the day. Other than that we need to go in and out through the gates which are manned by uniformed and civilian guards.

He brought back pictures of the girl he was meeting. If he had been caught he would have received a lot of demerits and possibly been dismissed from the Academy. I don't think Jay spent much time worrying about the consequences of his actions. I was never tempted to put my education at risk; it was too important to me to complete the course.

The Academy has a strict honor code the essence of which is "thou shalt not lie, cheat or steal, nor tolerate that in others." Neither do we snitch on our classmates but if we observed someone lying, cheating or stealing we were honor bound to turn him in. I never had a thought about turning Jay in and I guess he never concerned himself about being turned in. I didn't think he was lying, cheating or stealing; he was simply beating the system. Go Jay!

One afternoon when he wasn't out in town, he had some balloons which we filled with water and dropped from the window of our fourth floor room. They landed in the vicinity of some upper classmen below who were interrupted in sunning themselves by splashing water. Soon after that we were visited by those upper classmen asking if we knew anything about the water filled balloons. We denied any knowledge of that and heard no more about it. That was in the category of boys being boys, not a case of moral turpitude, fortunately.

One of the duties of the First and Second Classmen (seniors and juniors) is to indoctrinate the new Plebes. The goal of the indoctrination is to push each Plebe beyond his comfort level, having him research questions and report back, memorize the "Laws of the Navy", have uniform races, demonstrate how to tie a necktie in a Windsor knot among many other tasks. The "Laws of the Navy" consist of at least 24 four line lyrics; I memorized most of them and recited them in order in front of one or more upper classmen. I also had to stand on top of a desk and demonstrate how to tie a Windsor knot to a number

of my classmates and others. I knew how to do it but it took a few tries to get it right in front of an audience.

Usually an upper classman asks a question during a meal and the Plebe either answers the question or replies, "I'll find out, sir." To respond, "I don't know," is unacceptable. If he didn't know the answer he was expected to have the answer at the next meal. We didn't have computers to research information so we had to use books and other materials available. Finding answers to questions required time that might otherwise have been used for studying.

Plebes are required to walk down the center of corridors and make square corners in Bancroft Hall. Before each meal a Plebe announces the menu for that meal, from memory in a loud voice. This is done on each floor and each end of each corridor in Bancroft Hall. Every item on the menu is shouted out in the order listed in the menu. If a Plebe makes an error and an upper classman catches it, the Plebe is likely to receive a "come around." A "come around" is an order to report to the upper classman's room at a specific time, in a specific uniform with a detailed answer to a question. If the upper classman is not satisfied with the Plebe's answer to a question, his general performance or appearance, the Plebe is likely to receive another "come around." This process can continue until the Plebe performs satisfactorily or decides to leave the Academy.

While dining in the mess hall, Plebes are required to sit up straight on the edge of their chairs. Sometimes they are told to "shove out" which means to sit up straight without a chair. They may be told to eat a square meal which is to bring the food up to their mouths and back to their plates using square corners. Most upper classmen do not want a Plebe to fail and leave the Academy. They want to test the person, and help him learn to perform under stress. This is something military people need to do when in a combat situation.

All of this indoctrination is in addition to the primary job of a midshipman, to attend class and get an education. A normal class load is five classes each semester plus physical education.

Each class meets every day and each class has a quiz every day. Some classes meet on Saturday as well. The weekend begins after the noon meal on Saturday and ends before the evening meal formation on Sunday.

Each midshipman is required to participate in a sport during the academic year. Usually classes end at 3 PM followed by sports until 5, then “free” time until dinner formation at 6:30. It is during the “free” time from 5 until 6:30 that “come arounds” occur. Sometimes a Plebe will be dismissed from his “come around” at 6:25 or later, and must be in evening meal formation at 6:30 in a different uniform ready for inspection. If he is late or fails inspection, he is written up and receives demerits.

Demerits must be marched off outside of regular hours, usually before breakfast or on the weekend. The midshipman reports with his rifle in a working uniform and marches for an hour for each 5 demerits received. Different numbers of demerits are awarded for different infractions. A midshipman who receives a large number of demerits may come before a conduct review board and may be discharged if he is judged to be unfit for the service, or may be placed on probation subject to improving his performance. Senator John McCain⁵ came close to being discharged when he was a midshipman for having large numbers of demerits. He was the son and grandson of Admirals and was the target of extra attention by the upper class and even his Company Officer.

As the year progresses some of the indoctrination is toned down and Plebes enjoy a more normal routine. During football season, when Navy wins a game, Plebes are given “carry on” from after the game until Sunday night. “Carry on” means that Plebes are not required to do all the Plebe things and are treated as regular midshipmen. If Navy wins the Army-Navy game, Plebes are given “carry on” from after the game until the start of Christmas leave. On the night 100 days before graduation Plebes exchange roles with First Classmen (seniors). Plebes assume the power role and First Classmen do whatever the

⁵USNA class of 1958

Plebes order. Everybody takes their new roles in good humor and each gains some appreciation for the other.

Plebes cannot date girls⁶ until the academic year ends in June Week. The other three classes can date on the weekend when girls arrive from nearby colleges, typically on Saturday, and stay in drag houses. A drag is a midshipman's date. A drag house is a rooming house where drags stay in Annapolis.

I was in the Midshipman concert band Plebe year. The major benefit from being in the band, other than playing an instrument, is that we played concerts at women's colleges. We went to Goucher College in Towson, MD and Hood College in Fredericksburg, MD. We played a concert and afterwards attended a dance at the college. I met a girl from Hood College who came to Annapolis for June Week. I don't know if Ross Perot⁷ was in the Midshipman band, he was several years before my time, but I do know that he met and married a woman from Goucher.

Plebe year ends with the famous "plebes-no-more" ceremony, after graduation during June Week. The plebes all work together to climb the greased Herndon Monument and replace a Dixie cup hat on top with a uniform dress cap. The Herndon Monument is a grey obelisk like the Washington Monument except it is about thirty feet high. It is greased with lard by upper classman. The way the monument is climbed is to make a human pyramid such that one midshipman can scale the human pyramid and reach up and place the uniform cap on top. This is the official end of the plebe year.

⁶this term likely refers to college-aged women

⁷USNA class of 1953

My Youngster Cruise at the US Naval Academy

The second year begins with Youngster cruise. Each summer the new First, Second and Third Classmen (seniors or Firsties, juniors or Segundos and sophomores or Youngsters) embark on a summer training experience. For the Firsties and Youngsters it is a cruise on a Navy ship, with the Firsties acting as officers and the Youngsters acting as enlisted sailors. For the Segundos it is amphibious training with the Marines at Little Creek, VA and Navy Air training at Pensacola, FL. The training is part of the education of a midshipman and provides a basis for service selection prior to graduation. It usually covers six to eight weeks and is followed by three to four weeks of leave. Then it's back to the Academy for the academic year.

For Youngster cruise I was assigned to the destroyer USS BASILONE (DD824), stationed in Norfolk, VA. The BASILONE was part of a task force of Navy ships comprised of the battleship USS IOWA (BB 61), the guided missile cruiser USS CANBERRA (CAG 2) and several destroyers from Norfolk which was assembled for the purpose of training midshipmen, both from the Naval Academy and NROTC.

Built in 1940, the USS IOWA served our country for over 50 years. Designated the "World's Greatest Naval Ship" due to her big guns, heavy armor, fast speed, longevity and modernization, she kept pace with technology for more than 50 years. The USS CANBERRA was the second guided missile cruiser in the Navy.



The USS BASILONE

It has been scrapped along with all of the destroyers. The USS IOWA is tied up in Los Angeles as an educational museum and tourist attraction.

The task force conducted operations in the Caribbean Sea enroute to Rio de Janeiro, Brazil. After a few days at sea we put in to Guantanamo Bay, Cuba. There was a party at the Officer's Club for the midshipmen that evening during which free beer was provided. I had never had a beer prior to this and I had a few that night. We went back to the ship for the night and got underway the next morning. I was really thirsty, had a drink of water and that seemed to reconstitute the beer I had drunk the night before. Then I was assigned a battle station in the rotating projectile and powder cage under the 5" gun mount. With the ship pitching and rolling, the cage rotating around me and feeling a little queasy from the beer, it was a

day to remember.

I was assigned to the deck division for the first half of the cruise. The other division to which we were assigned is the engineering division. The deck division is responsible for the operation and maintenance of all machinery and guns on deck. What I remember most is scraping and painting the forward deck on the ship. We used steel hand scrapers to remove deteriorated paint and rust, then applied a coat of zinc chromate, then gray paint. When we were done the deck looked really nice. The problem was that in a few weeks, we had to do the job again. We did it on our way to Rio and on our way back from Rio. Sea water is a terrible environment for steel decks and other equipment.



Midshipmen on deck of the USS BASILONE

The other job of an enlisted man aboard ship is to stand watch. Deck division watches consist of steering the ship,

operating the engine order telegraph and standing lookout. Destroyers in the 1950s and 60s had large steering wheels which controlled the ship's rudders and thus the course of the ship. Usually the helmsman was given a course by the OOD (Officer of the Deck) and did his best to steer that course using the compass just ahead of the wheel. If you have ever steered a boat you know you have to continuously correct the course as the ship moves from one side to the other of the course. Sometimes an inexperienced helmsman will overcorrect or turn in the opposite direction and the ship veers off course. It takes some experience to keep the ship on course.



The USS IOWA (right) sailing in formation

Navy ships often sail in formation, with the destroyers in a circle around the battleship or aircraft carrier. The purpose is to protect the big ship from attack by submarine or aircraft. When the formation changes course, each ship has to move smartly to the same position relative to the big ship on the new course. The destroyers in the circle around the big ship have to speed up or slow down and turn to maintain the circle intact during

the maneuver, watching for other ships doing similar maneuvers to avoid collision. The helmsman has to do precisely as ordered to get to the new station safely.

Another critical steering situation is when going alongside a ship for refueling, replenishing stores and transferring personnel. The ships are quite close together on the same course and speed with hoses for refueling or lines attached to both ships for transferring stores and people. It is critical for both ships to maintain the same course and speed to keep the distance between ships constant. It is essential to avoid tightening or breaking the lines, sideswiping the other ship or slacking the lines and dropping people or material into the water.

The engine order telegraph sends orders from the bridge telling the sailors in the engine room the direction to turn the shafts and propellers, ahead or back, and the speed, one third, two thirds or full speed. There was also a device to order the precise number of rpm's on the propellers, so that small changes in speed can occur when alongside another ship. I suspect most of this is done electronically today with autopilots; just set in the course and speed, and the ship follows that precisely. Lookouts stand on either side of the bridge to watch for and report contacts.

On the way to Rio we crossed the equator. Those who have crossed the equator by ship before and have been indoctrinated are known as shellbacks. Those who have not are called pollywogs. So, out in the ocean over the equator, we came before King Neptune's court to be indoctrinated. The thing I remember most vividly was crawling through a canvas tube about 18" in diameter and 15' long that contained copious amounts of lube oil and spaghetti. Fortunately there was a fire hose to wash off most of the mess. When the indoctrination was over we were shellbacks.

Part of the task force went to Rio and the rest went to the Port of Santos; we went to Santos. The Port of Santos is the largest port in South America, I'm not sure it was the largest port when we were there but its primary advantage to us was

that it is close to Sao Paulo, the largest city in Brazil. When we were not in the duty section we were able to take a bus or train to Sao Paulo. There were three duty sections in port so each duty section was on the ship two days and off four days which gave us the opportunity to spend a reasonable amount of time off the ship. We had our first mail call since we left Annapolis three or four weeks earlier. I was really disappointed that I didn't receive a single letter.

I remember that four of us midshipmen met four girls outside a sports arena in Sao Paulo. Brazilian people speak Portuguese but understand Spanish. With the help of an English-Portuguese dictionary and our knowledge of Spanish we were able to converse with Brazilian girls quite well. I guess the girls gave us a tour of Sao Paulo, and we met up with them a second time, because I have a photograph of one of the girls who was apparently quite taken with me. I guess I disappointed her as I was disappointed when nobody wrote to me. I heard later that one of my classmates flew back to Brazil to see a girl he met on Youngster cruise..

We went to Rio on one of our other liberty days, and saw the highlights: the statue of Christ the Redeemer on Corcovado Mountain, Sugarloaf Mountain with its cable car and Copacabana Beach with white sand and scantily clad women. I guess we went to a bar or two and then went back to the ship. I, for one, was pretty naïve at that stage of my life. Last year, some 56 years later, Carol and I went back to Rio and spent three days getting reacquainted with the city and its people.

After we left the Port of Santos we headed back to Norfolk. It was pretty much the same as the trip down but now I was in the Engineering Division. The Engineering Division is responsible for the operation and maintenance of the ship's engines, boilers, pumps, pipes, tanks and all the various components that make the ship go through the water. The boilers are fired with fuel oil which makes steam which drives the turbines and propels the ship. The steam is then condensed back into water which is fed back to the boiler to repeat the cycle. One of the things I

remember was crawling on top of a water tank to read the level of the tank using a rod that went to the bottom of the tank, like a dip stick in your car. I read the level and wrote it into a log book every watch. Underway watches are usually four hours on and eight hours off. So we spent four hours on watch in the engine or boiler room, eight hours off, then repeated the cycle. During the eight hours off we slept, ate, wrote letters and did whatever studying or other tasks we needed to do.

On the trip back to Norfolk we didn't stop at another port until we reached San Juan, Puerto Rico. I'm sure we played war games, practicing guarding the IOWA, firing our 5" guns and looking for submarines with our sonar. I remember the old city of San Juan, some pretty beaches and not much else. After arriving in Norfolk, we went back to the Naval Academy and left for four weeks leave.

My Life as a Youngster at the Naval Academy

After Youngster cruise and four weeks of leave, we return to the banks of the Severn River (Annapolis) for our second academic year. The best thing about Youngster year is that we are no longer Plebes. We have no special duties other than to participate in all the Midshipman activities including meal formations, parades, sports and classes without the distraction of come-arounds, memorizing things, looking up the answers to questions and the like.

I ended up in a five man room, with my Plebe roommate, John Schmidt, and three others: Gary Helms, George Gould and Brad Purinton. The room had five beds, five desks, five steel cabinets for uniforms and other clothing and no shower. We had to use the shower in the room across the hall which belonged to three Plebes. One of the Plebes was Joe Bellino who won the Heisman Trophy at Navy in 1960, his junior year. That was our year of graduation. As a matter of interest, Roger Staubach won the Heisman Trophy at Navy in 1963, his junior year. He was the last service academy player to win a Heisman Trophy. Navy was ranked #2 in the nation.

Youngsters are permitted to drag (date) women at the Naval Academy, which was a big advantage over being a Plebe. I dated a gal from Goucher College several times, Sandy Waymer. We met after one of our band concerts at Goucher. She was a freshman from Princeton, NJ. She would come down from

Towson, MD, north of Baltimore, on Saturday, we'd go out to dinner in Annapolis, then attend a dance at the Academy. She would stay at a drag house in Annapolis and return to Goucher on Sunday. All midshipmen had to be back in Bancroft Hall a half hour after the end of the dance. There was no opportunity to spend the night with your date as happens occasionally in civilian colleges.

The Naval Academy had its own band, comprised of Navy musicians, not midshipmen. The band played for dances, formal parades on the parade ground and other occasions. We also had a midshipman Drum & Bugle Corps which marched in parades and sometimes played at noon meal formations, mostly for the benefit of tourists. We had lots of extracurricular activities to participate in, including the concert band, a couple of different choruses, thespians, sailing, intramural sports as well as varsity and JV. I think that facilities at the Naval Academy are the best money can buy, and students should use them to the fullest. As an example, there are dozens of sailboats for recreational sailing, dinghys for intercollegiate competition and large sailboats for ocean racing. Most of these facilities are funded by taxpayers, but a fairly significant portion is funded by donations from alumni, parents of midshipmen and friends of the Academy, to augment the basic government funding.

We didn't have computers in 1957, we didn't even have calculators; we had slide rules for use in math classes. It's amazing how far technology has come in a mere 55 years or so. In math we took trigonometry and other courses but did not take calculus. Today most students entering college have at least a year of calculus. Each Midshipman had to take two years of a language so this was our second year of Spanish. Having taken two years of Spanish in high School, I was in a more advanced class and made excellent grades. We could not test out of courses; every Midshipman took the same courses, except different languages. We took English, chemistry, math, courses in Naval warfare, ship handling, gunnery and physical education.

Youngster year is a letdown from Plebe year as far as

indoctrination goes. As a Plebe you are the center of attention, with the upper classes testing you continually to see how you react and handle the stress of the situation. As a Youngster you are just part of the scenery, not contributing much but not in the center of attention. It's kind of a time to regroup and set your sights on the next three years leading to graduation and a commission as an officer in the Navy or Marine Corps. Having survived Plebe year we are ready to stay the course to the end. Some say that after completing Plebe year, the Navy owes us the next three. The Navy didn't owe us anything; the Navy gave us the opportunity of a lifetime at an elite institution paid for by the taxpayers of our country. In recognition and appreciation for that opportunity we should have done our very best in every aspect of the Academy. The smart ones did exactly that. Too many of us were able to do okay by giving less than our best. That was the dumbest thing I ever did, and I did some dumb things. Some Midshipmen struggled to pass the courses and stay at the Academy.

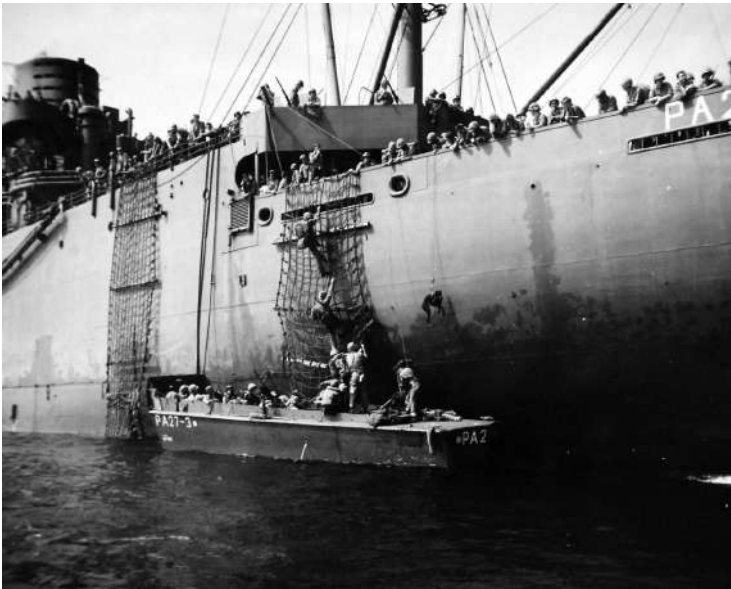
Second Class Summer at the US Naval Academy

Second Class summer starts at the end of our second (Youngster) year at the Academy. It consists basically of two parts, amphibious training at Little Creek, VA and Naval Aviation training at Pensacola, FL. Little Creek is just outside Norfolk, VA and adjacent to Virginia Beach, a nice place to spend a few weeks of the summer. Pensacola is on the Florida panhandle, is famous for its white sand beaches and is another nice place to visit. The Navy surely does own some fantastic real estate, much of it on the ocean. We also visited Glynco Naval Air Station in GA for a look at the Navy's lighter than air craft, blimps.

Amphibious operations are the means by which Marines travel from Navy ships offshore to the beaches. The major difference between the Marine Corps and the Army is that the marines embark on ships and land on beaches, and the Army usually lands at an airstrip or parachutes from an airplane and moves over land. The Marine Corps is a small force compared to the Army, and much more specialized. Congress proposes to do away with the Marine Corps from time to time as a money saving measure, but so far proponents of the Marine Corps have prevailed.

Landing craft are the boats that transport Marines from ships to the beaches. We got to ride in and drive landing craft as part of our training. One of the most used landing

craft in WWII and into the 1950s was the LCVP, landing craft vehicle personnel. It was constructed from plywood, with a shallow-draft, a barge-like shape, and it could ferry a platoon-sized complement of 36 men to shore at 9 knots. Men generally entered the boat by climbing down a cargo net hung from the side of their ship; they exited by charging down the boat's bow ramp. This boat was used to ferry men from ships offshore to the beaches of Normandy in 1944.



Climbing down a cargo net from the ship onto an LCVP

We climbed down cargo nets into the boats, rode to the beach and ran out of the ramp on the bow of the boat into the water and onto the beach. We also drove the landing craft from the ship up to the beach, discharged our classmates playing the role of Marines and ran back out to the ship for another group of classmates.

After two or three weeks in Little Creek we flew to NAS

Glynco to observe the operation of the Navy's blimps. The blimps were used in WWII off the East Coast to search for German submarines and escort cargo ships heading for Europe with war materials. The base was maintained after WWII for the possible use of blimps in future conflicts, which didn't happen. In hindsight I think they took us to Glynco to fill a gap in the schedule between Little Creek and Pensacola.

Then we flew to Pensacola for indoctrination in Naval Aviation. We got to fly the Navy's T34 trainer aircraft, a piston engine propeller plane based on the Beechcraft Bonanza. Actually we were in the front seat with a qualified Navy pilot in the back seat. In the late 1950s, pilots started out in the prop planes and then moved on to jets. I suspect they start out in jets, since there are virtually no prop planes used in the military today.



A T34 trainer aircraft

In any case, the new Navy pilots wanted to show us not only some of the basics of flying but also what the plane was capable

of doing. So we flew some big loops, taking the plane up and over, and upside down and around. We did some stalls and recoveries which pilots need to be prepared for and know how to recover from. Fortunately we were issued barf bags before we took off and I, for one, made use of it. I decided that if my stomach couldn't handle the acrobatics, Naval Aviation was probably not a good choice for me. I also think you need to love flying to make that your career choice, and I didn't like it that much at the time.

It turns out that I also got sick on a destroyer at times so I probably could have overcome the air sickness. But it was just as well that I didn't select Naval Aviation since landing on an aircraft carrier at sea is what distinguishes a Naval Aviator from any other aviator. Landing on a carrier has been described as a controlled crash, and many Naval Aviators are lost in accidents at sea, even in peacetime. So, I did not select Naval Aviation but I did get a good taste of it and I did live to tell about it.

Those white sands of Pensacola Beach beckoned on the weekend, and there were many young women who also heeded the call. Nothing interesting developed on that front, the Naval Aviation phase ended, we went back to Annapolis and left for our four weeks of leave. As I recall John McCain met his first wife in Pensacola after he had graduated from the Academy and reported to Pensacola for aviation training. John was quite a man about town and had lots of capers wherever he was.

Second Class Year at the US Naval Academy

Having completed two years it was time to begin the last two years, starting our junior year. During our Third Class (sophomore) year we were pretty much non-entities. We were present but we didn't say much or do much in terms of indoctrinating the Plebes. Now we were responsible, under the guidance of the First Class (seniors), to guide and test the new Plebes in matters of military knowledge and bearing. We gave come-arounds, inspected uniforms, asked questions and sought to determine how the new Plebes reacted under pressure and stress.

This was the year in which we began to study more engineering, science and military subjects. We had completed our two years of Spanish language and our math courses, and now we studied thermodynamics, strength of materials, naval history, leadership and the like. In each succeeding year the weighting of our grade in leadership (grease) increased, so men with high scores increased their class standing even if some of their academic grades were lower. In our First Class (senior) year, men with the highest grades in leadership became strippers or leaders in the Brigade. Said another way, the men with the stripes had the highest grades in leadership.

It was during this year that I got reacquainted with Dottie Chandler who was in my high school class but went to Goucher College on a scholarship after her junior year. It was at her going

away party that I first tried water skiing and became hooked on the sport. Dottie was a senior while I was a junior since she skipped her senior year of high school. She came down to the Academy a few times to attend dances. We also went to D.C. for a weekend with a friend of hers and her boyfriend who had left the Academy before graduating.

Dottie was sexually experienced, having had a serious relationship with a Frenchman (Etienne), and probably others, for one or more years prior. I was still a virgin not having had the opportunity or forwardness to pursue girls, and valuing my education more than sex. During the last two years of being at the Academy the Navy made every effort to pay off or otherwise take care of girls who got pregnant by Midshipmen. But I wasn't of a mind to pursue that life.

On the D.C. weekend we went to the National Museum of Art and visited some of the highlights of our nation's capitol. One of the other highlights was she attempted to seduce me. But it was not successful and we didn't see much of one another after that.

Since she was graduating from college at the end of the year she was deciding where to go for her Masters degree. Her two top choices were the University of Maryland and American University in Beirut, Lebanon. She asked for my opinion and I recommended Maryland because I thought it was a safer choice for a young woman. She chose Maryland and met her future husband there. He was Hispanic and became a MD, I think. She had three children and one or more of them became MDs as well. I asked her many years later if she had any regrets about having chosen Maryland instead of Beirut and she said no. My friend Doug Watts was in Maryland pursuing his Masters during the time Dottie was there. He remarked on the fact that she was involved with a Hispanic man.

One of the most memorable events of Second Class year was getting our class rings. Toward the end of the academic year we ordered our rings from Jostens. The basic rings were all identical but we were able to select from a number of available stones, real or synthetic. Star sapphires were popular as well

as diamonds, some set into other stones. I selected a synthetic blue sapphire with facets on top. If I were to do it today I would select something more original and interesting but I still think my ring is very special.

At the end of Second Class year, during June week, is the Ring Dance. The Ring Dance is for Second Class midshipmen and their dates only, because this is the ceremony in which our rings are dipped in water from the seven seas and we are committed and proud to wear them forever. The ceremony starts with the midshipman's date wearing the ring on a blue ribbon around her neck at the beginning of the dance. Then the couple gets in line leading to a large replica of our ring; once the couple gets inside the ring, the girl removes the ring from her neck and dips it in a small container filled with water from the seven seas. Then she removes the ribbon and places the ring on the midshipman's ring finger of his left hand. At such time as the man desires to wear a wedding ring, he can purchase one that is made to fit next to the Class ring. This places your wedding on a somewhat equal footing with your Academy experience.

Sandy Waymer was my date for the ring dance. We dated off and on during my Third Class and Second Class years which were her freshman and sophomore years. She even came to Lakeport for a few days one summer. During my First Class year we must have found other interests; just before my graduation I called and asked her to go out with me, a friend and his date, and she really didn't want to go. I finally convinced her but I should have taken no for an answer. She went to the American University in Beirut and I wrote to her while stationed on USS MADDUX. She wrote back telling me much about looking forward to being the wife of a minister. I never responded to that and never heard from her again. I hope she had a good life as the wife of a minister.

With Navy ships deployed around the world, many commanded by Naval Academy graduates who had their rings dipped in water from the seven seas at the end of their Second Class year, it is not difficult to obtain a small container of water to send back to the Academy from each of the seven



At a Naval Academy formal dance

seas. The seven oceans of the world currently are considered to be the North Atlantic, South Atlantic, North Pacific, South Pacific, Indian, Arctic and Antarctic. According to Wikipedia,

in different ages and different countries other oceans and seas made up the seven.

Once the current First Class graduates, we become the First Class. Having received our class rings and the right to wear them after the ceremony at the ring Dance, we are the ring knockers. First Class can enter a lower classmen's room anytime other than during study hours, and often make their presence known by rapping their ring on the door before entering, ring knocking. Only First Class have that distinction. We didn't get the opportunity to barge in on any Plebes since they were now Youngsters and the new Plebe class would not arrive for a few more weeks. At the conclusion of June Week we were off on First Class cruise which I will discuss next.

First Class Cruise at the US Naval Academy

Now that we were First Class (seniors) midshipmen we acted as officers aboard the ships to which we were assigned. My ship was the aircraft carrier, USS LAKE CHAMPLAIN (CV 39), which was operating in the Mediterranean Sea. To join up with the ship we flew from Norfolk to Naples, Italy. In 1959 we flew in prop planes, which had to go via Newfoundland and Morocco, North Africa to refuel before embarking on the next leg of our journey. We spent the night in Morocco, in a BOQ on base which we were not able to leave, took off after breakfast and arrived in Naples that afternoon. There were around 30 midshipmen in my group, all from the Naval Academy, no NROTC midshipmen.

In the evening we visited the city of Naples where I purchased a number of cameos for some of the women in my family, and returned to the ship. These were hand crafted cameos which my mother and grandmother wore with pride for many years. The next morning we were underway on LAKE CHAMPLAIN for operations in the Mediterranean as a unit of the Sixth Fleet.

Navy ships usually deploy to the Mediterranean for six months. The ship had probably been in the Med for about four months when we arrived, and we spent two months including the voyage across the Atlantic to Norfolk. So we experienced only about a third of the deployment.

After a couple of weeks' operations we stopped at the city



The USS LAKE CHAMPLAIN in 1960

of Barcelona, Spain. We anchored out in the harbor and took personnel launches (boats that held about 50 people) to get ashore. The in port watch was organized in three sections, one section on duty and the other two sections permitted to leave the ship for a few days at a time. That allowed us to travel.

Three of us traveled together. We spent the first afternoon at a beach on the Med outside Barcelona. We conversed with a young woman at the beach, native Spanish, and she told us about the area. After that we rented a new Simca automobile and headed east, up the coast toward Cannes, Nice and Monaco, just the three of us. We arrived in Cannes and found an inexpensive hotel a few blocks back from the beach.

Cannes has a sandy beach and lots of large private yachts in a marina near the beach. There were lots of young women on the beach in skimpy bikinis, and quite a few older women, some obese, also in skimpy bikinis. Men also wore skimpy bikinis.

This was the first time I witnessed a woman changing from beach bikini to street clothes inside a towel on the beach. I thought that was pretty cool. I never saw one lose control of the towel or the situation while changing.

After a couple of days in Cannes we moved up the coast to Nice. The beach at Nice is characterized by round stones in the place of sand on the beach. I don't remember much about our meals; I know we had French bread and wine more than once. We weren't poor but we didn't have a lot of money to spend. We surely didn't frequent the better places to eat. I'd like to tell about our romances with the native women along the way, but there weren't any, romances that is.

Then we were on to Monaco. The thing I remember about Monaco was that the city is built on a hill coming down to the water. There were large yachts on the waterfront which we observed from a distance, and the gambling hall which we visited but didn't gamble at. The streets were narrow and it was challenging to drive the car there. Grace Kelly was Princess Grace at the time, although we didn't see her and we didn't call on her at the palace. At some point we drove the rental car along the coast overlooking the Med which was beautiful. It was during this time that Bridget Bardot was a famous actress, and I believe she had a place in the vicinity that overlooked the sea. So we had some of the same vistas enjoyed by the rich and famous.

We went back to the ship for duty for a few days; then we had another opportunity to get away. This time we had a choice of going to a bull fight in Barcelona or flying to Mallorca for a couple of days. We chose Mallorca, an island off the coast of Spain. The plane we flew in was a Ford tri-motor. The Ford tri-motor was built by companies of Henry Ford from 1925 until 1933. There were 199 built and they were used all over the world. They were getting kind of old and rickety by the time we flew to Mallorca in 1959, but we made it, over and back.

We flew into Palma, the capital of Mallorca, which was then and is still a tourist destination because of its beaches mostly. We spent parts of two days and one night there, basically just

walking around the city. Then we flew back to Barcelona, back to the ship. The ship got underway and left port the next day.

Operations at sea were mostly launching and retrieving aircraft, both during daylight and at night. In the two months I was on board we lost two planes and two pilots. The most dangerous part of flying off a carrier is landing, setting your aircraft down on a postage stamp which is tossing and turning in the middle of the ocean. I don't remember how our pilots were lost but I remember vividly that they were.

One job I had was launch control officer. I was on the flight deck beside the aircraft being launched, and I gave the signal to the pilot and the catapult officer to launch. That was fun and interesting. I never lost a plane during my launches.

After another couple of weeks we went through the Strait of Gibraltar and put into Lisbon, Portugal. Lisbon is on the eastern side of the Atlantic Ocean and has nice ocean beaches. I remember the colorful beach houses, actually beach tents, on the Lisbon beach. What I remember more specifically is the cork store. They had everything imaginable made out of cork. While we were shopping we had a free glass of wine which was bottomless. I guess it was intended to help us decide which of the many items we would purchase, the more the better. I bought some coasters and not much else. Portugal produces about 50% of the world's cork, much of it for stoppers in wine bottles. It is from the bark of the cork Oak tree.

Then it was off across the Atlantic to Norfolk. In 1945 LAKE CHAMPLAIN set the record for the fastest Atlantic crossing, about four days, nine hours, which stood until it was broken by SS United States in 1952. It was a new ship in 1945 and the price of fuel was much lower. As I recall we made the crossing in six or seven days.

First Class Year at the Naval Academy

Looking back on it, the first three years went by pretty quickly. It didn't seem like it at the time, especially Plebe year, but we finally made it. One more academic year and we'll graduate with Bachelors' Degrees in Naval Science and a commission as an Ensign in the Navy or a Second Lieutenant in the Marine Corps. There is no need to send out resumes, nor interview for jobs; we know we have a good job waiting, we just don't know where it is yet. Depending on class standing we will select the service and the specialty we want toward the end of the year.

We are now the stripers (leaders) of the Brigade of Midshipmen. At all meal formations and parades we command the lower classes as well as our classmates who are not in leadership positions during this set. The year is divided into three sets: half the First Class command during the first set, until Christmas leave, the other half during the second set, until spring, and the best of the first two during the third set, until graduation. For Christmas leave both the first and second set stripers get to wear their stripes home. Upon return from Christmas leave, the stripes are removed from the uniforms of the first set of stripers.

Stripes are sewn on the sleeves of dress uniforms denoting the rank of the person wearing the uniform, from one stripe to six stripes, in a manner similar to Naval Officers. The six striper is the Brigade Commander (1), highest ranking midshipman in

the class. The five strippers are Regimental Commanders (2), four strippers are Battalion Commanders (6), three strippers are Company Commanders (24), two strippers are platoon leaders (48) and one strippers are squad leaders (144). I was a one stripper which I have always felt somewhat disappointed about. I was surely capable of more; I just didn't distinguish myself at anything and I didn't get out and show what I was capable of.

In hindsight, one stripe was not all that bad. There were about ninety two strippers and above in each set for a total of 180 for the two sets. There were about 800 men in my class. So the two strippers and above constituted the top 25% of the class in leadership. I was probably about where I deserved to be. If I had distinguished myself in some manner I might have had more stripes. Having come from a working class family in NH, I thought I did well to get into the Naval Academy, to graduate and to end up in the top third of the class.

First Class Midshipmen receive more privileges than the lower classes. We can take weekends off and go places away from Annapolis. We can have cars during the latter part of the second semester. We can wear civilian clothes when we go away for a weekend. It has been more than three years since we arrived at the Academy and sent our civilian clothes home in a box. We are beginning to acclimate back into civilian society.

On campus we assume leadership positions on our sports teams; varsity, JV and intramural. I was the captain of our company cross country team in the fall. We practiced most days after class and competed against other companies on certain days. The better we did the more points we earned for our company. The company that earned the most points on the various competitions at the end of the year was designated the Color Company.

The Color Company was honored at a parade during June Week and the date of the Company Commander of the Color Company was the Color Girl who was recognized during a special ceremony on the parade grounds. She wore a wide brimmed hat and colorful dress, and transferred the Colors from the previous color company to the new one. There were

probably other perks for the Color Company but we were not it and I don't remember what they were.

On the hundredth day before graduation we exchanged places with the Plebes in our company. They gave the orders and we followed, in a manner similar to what we had done three years earlier. At the evening meal we got to eat square meals, shove out, answer questions and get harassed as they have been for the last several months. It tends to be somewhat subdued since the tables turn around the next morning, and the Plebes have 100 more days to weather the wrath of an angry First Classman. I must have been treated quite well since I don't remember any specifics. I was always fair in my treatment of the Plebes.

Toward the end of the year we had service selection night. Each First Classman, in order of class standing, selected which branch of the service and which specialty he wanted to pursue. I stood in the top third of the class so I had a choice of most anything I wanted. I chose Navy surface ships. My roommate chose Navy submarines and went to Submarine School after graduation. Others chose Navy air, Navy nuclear power program, Navy Supply Corps and various Marine Corps specialties.

About two thirds of the class chose Navy and one third chose Marine Corps. We may have had one or two choose Army or Air Force but 99.9% picked Navy or Marine Corps. That's why we went to the Naval Academy.

June week is filled with parades, dances and other activities leading up to graduation. At graduation we all wear the uniforms of the service we have chosen, so there are lots of shiny new Ensigns and Second Lieutenants. Usually we are addressed by the President of the United States or the Vice President or the Secretary of Defense who then hands out our diplomas and commissions. We were honored to have Admiral Arleigh "31 Knot" Burke, the Chief of Naval Operations, as our commencement speaker. At the end of the program the graduating class flings its midshipman dress hats into the air to be caught by under classmen and family members. Then they



Sarah Mack, Edy, Bob, Dick, and Zaida at graduation

have their new Ensign shoulder boards or Second Lieutenant gold bars pinned on by a family member. It's a proud moment for the new Officer, his family and friends; the culmination of four years of effort and determination. It was sometimes not a great place to be at, but it has been proven to be a great place to be from.

My mother and father put on my new Ensign shoulder boards and I was officially a Naval Officer with a Bachelors degree in Naval Science. It was the culmination of four years of effort and persistence, and I was happy to be leaving Annapolis. During June Week I purchased my 1958 Chevy Impala convertible from the Chrysler/Plymouth dealer in Annapolis. During a weekend in Washington, DC I had purchased a 1957 Plymouth sedan, a rather unremarkable car. When I saw the Chevy convertible in the dealer's lot I wanted it and thought I might get a deal on the car. I think I did. I had my parents sell a couple of life insurance policies taken out when I was a baby and bring the proceeds to Annapolis with



Sarah Mack at graduation

them. They were small policies for which they paid \$0.25 a week or something like that.

I drove the car back to New Hampshire with my mother, to begin my thirty days leave before reporting to the USS MADDOX in Long Beach, CA. We took the New Jersey Turnpike and I felt really good as I looked forward to leave and embarked on the next phase of my life.

Life in the Navy

Thirty Days' Leave After Graduation from the Naval Academy

My first priority was getting my boat in the water and going tooling around Lake Winnepesaukee. One of the first places I went was Marguerite's camp on Moultonboro Second Neck, next to the bridge to Black Cat Island. When we were growing up, Black Cat Island was uninhabited and there was no bridge. By the time I graduated it was fully developed with a cottage every 100' of shore line.

Marguerite and Bud were very prudent when it came to purchasing their waterfront property. After WWII Winnepesaukee waterfront was being developed. They purchased their 100' of waterfront in 1950 for \$500 or thereabouts. That was a goodly amount of money at the time but it turned out to be a wonderful investment both in terms of enjoyment and money. I took note of that and determined that I would purchase some waterfront on Winnepesaukee after graduation when I had the means to pay for it. It turned out that there was really none to be found in my price range. But the dream lived on.

Marguerite and Bud's friends, Mai and Chet Brickett, owned a cabin colony in Winnisquam, and he was able to build a small cabin for them on the property. Mother, Edy and I enjoyed going to the camp for swimming and cookouts and such. My

father didn't have much interest in that. When I had my boat we went water skiing and used the round disk I made for towing behind the boat, turning circles and such. Marguerite and her girls, Joyce and Peggy, spent time at the camp when they could. Bud had a small boat and liked to fish. Marguerite had a full time job working at the Forest Service in Laconia. It was the headquarters of the White Mountain National Forest, and she was administrative assistant to the Director. It was a US Civil Service position from which she retired with a pension at age 55. In 1960 she was 50 years old.

Grandmother Mack (Daddoo) offered to escort Joyce, my Naval Academy classmate, Charlie Roberts, and me to Nova Scotia to meet some of our relatives for a couple of weeks. Charlie had his 1957 Plymouth and I had my 1958 Chevrolet. He offered to drive the four of us. Hopefully I paid for most of the gas on the trip. We drove all the way up and took the ferry back from Yarmouth, NS to Bar Harbor, ME.



The old Mack homestead, in 2010

Charlie had roots in Nova Scotia on his mother's side so we visited her home there. While we were visiting places dear to Charlie, Daddoo and Joyce visited with relatives. It pains me now that I didn't have the foresight or interest to take notes on

the people we met. My most vivid memory is of a breakfast of fried eggs and bacon, lots of grease, and toast at a farm house.



Dick and Diana entering Mill Village in 2010

When Carol, Diana and I visited Nova Scotia in 2010 we went to the town of Millville, also known as Mackville because of the number and prominence of the Macks in that town. We stopped and knocked on the door of a Mack, talked to the woman who answered the door, and she gave us some genealogy of the Mack family. We visited a cemetery and saw lots of gravestones with Mack on them.

We also went to West Berlin where Daddoo was born and grew up; we stopped and knocked on the door of a house where the name Corkum, Daddoo's maiden name, was on the mailbox. We managed to revisit a woman, Daddoo's nephew's wife, (her

My Service Aboard USS MADDOX (DD 731)

In the latter part of our senior year, 1960, we had service selection night. In order of class standing we selected the service we wanted (Navy surface, Navy submarines, Navy nuclear power, Navy air, or Marine Corps). I selected Navy surface and USS MADDOX (DD731) in Long Beach, CA. I selected Long Beach because I was not interested in being on a destroyer in the North Atlantic in winter. The warm Pacific Ocean was for me. I graduated in June 1960 as an Ensign, USN.

In July, after 30 days' leave in NH. I drove my new (to me) 1958 Chevrolet Impala convertible, which I bought in Annapolis during graduation week, across the country to Long Beach. It was a fun experience to be going to the West Coast to report to my first ship. I remember gas was very affordable at 35 cents a gallon. I went to the Bachelor Officer's Quarters (BOQ) at Long Beach Naval Shipyard to await the arrival of MADDOX. The ship was operating in the area off southern California so it wasn't long before she returned and I reported aboard.

My first assignment was as First Lieutenant, in charge of the guns, torpedoes, depth charges, fire control system and deck equipment such as anchors, windlass, and the condition of the ship structure. The thing I remember most about the job was that the fire control system didn't work very well. The fire control system is what controls the aiming of the guns, torpedoes



USS MADDOX in the early 1960s (from Wikipedia)

and depth charges and, if that doesn't work, the guns don't fire accurately, the torpedoes go astray and the depth charges miss their mark. So it's an important system.

MADDOX was a WWII destroyer, commissioned in June 1944. She participated in the latter part of WWII in the Pacific, in the Korean War and she operated between the west coast of the US and the Western Pacific after that. My point is that the ship was getting quite old (16 years) by the time I got aboard and the systems needed a lot of attention to work properly.

We typically operated off the coast of California during the week and came in on the weekend. If the equipment didn't work, people had to stay aboard and fix it before we got underway on Monday. I had sailors working for me who were trained in maintaining systems so they worked on them when they had weekend duty. We also got assistance from the destroyer tender which we tied up alongside. After four years of restricted

freedom, I longed to get out and see the larger world. I might have made points if I had stayed aboard over the weekend to work with and support my men but I didn't. I suspect that my classmates who did really well in the Navy were those who gave it near total attention. One of the measurable attributes of performance is time spent on the job. The more time you spend, the better your performance rating. My performance ratings were very good, not outstanding.

Before my first Christmas, 1960, having been aboard the ship less than six months, I requested leave to attend my sister's wedding in Washington, DC. The Captain disapproved my request since I had been aboard only a short time. A little later I attended a party in which the Captain's wife was present, and she inquired about my plans for the holidays. I said that I would be spending the holidays on the ship. I guess I mentioned that I had hoped to travel to the East Coast for my sister's wedding but my leave was not approved. The next day my leave was approved. Sometimes it's nice to have a female influence in a Navy dominated by men.



Dick (left) at Edy's wedding; Larry and Edy

My second assignment on MADDOX was as Combat Information Center (CIC) Officer, in charge of operation and maintenance of radar and other electronic equipment.

CIC was illuminated by the glow from radar scopes and backlighting from plotting boards, so it was quite dark until you got accustomed to the low lighting. It was where all the information from radar, sonar and ECM (electronic countermeasures) was fed and analyzed. Our primary mission was ASW (anti-submarine warfare) and our secondary mission was AAW (anti-air warfare). We plotted bearing and range information in real time from sonar and radar on separate plotting boards, and advised the Captain of the location, course and speed of enemy submarines and aircraft. This helped him plan an attack on a submarine and to defend the ship from incoming aircraft.

Every few years Navy ships go into overhaul. We went into Long Beach Naval Shipyard for a six month overhaul. This was the time to repair, upgrade or replace our tired equipment and systems. The Shipyard overhauls the more complex systems and the crew does the more routine work. This keeps everybody employed and keeps costs more reasonable. The officers keep track of the progress of work and meet with shipyard managers to resolve problems as they occur.

Having six months with the ship in overhaul provided a break from at sea operations. We worked a regular work day and work week with weekends off when we were not on duty. I was able to go to Catalina Island, to the Avalon Ballroom a couple of times. I also had a second cousin, Barbara, her husband Bill and two boys, who lived in the San Fernando Valley; I visited her and her family on weekends from time to time.

At the Avalon Ballroom I met a young woman, Joyce, who I became quite fond of. She was a college student and lived in the LA area. We dated a few times; I remember going to a drive-in movie and bringing her to meet Barbara, Bill and family. Bill had been an executive at a defense contractor making an excellent income which gave him the wherewithal to buy the home in the up-scale San Fernando Valley. But Bill had quit the job and taken to selling flowers on a street corner. A few times a week he went to the LA flower exchange in the early morning, bought flowers, brought them home and Barbara sold

them on the street corner. They did okay at that.

While I was deployed for six months, Joyce dated a young man who reminded her of Bill, and she and her boyfriend actually visited Barbara and Bill. I heard from Barbara later that Joyce had gotten pregnant and married the boyfriend, I guess.

Every two years, for about six months, Navy ships deploy to locations far from our home port. In our case we deployed to the Western Pacific (WestPac), traveling via Pearl Harbor, HI, to the vicinity of Japan, Okinawa, Philippines and Hong Kong, which we visited for R&R. We went with a squadron of eight destroyers, a carrier and a submarine. While operating we formed a screen (a ring) around the carrier to protect it from enemy submarines and planes. We practiced war games using our own submarine and planes from the carrier acting as the enemy. CIC is a very active place during a submarine or aircraft attack. The Captain is on the bridge controlling the ship and the Executive Officer is in CIC.

Being in the Western Pacific is not all work and no play. We visit interesting ports in all the places we go to, particularly Japan. Sasebo, Japan stands out for a couple of reasons: one is that I got promoted to Lt(jg)⁹ and we had a big party in Sasebo.

The other is that I met a lovely Japanese girl there, in a bar. The girls would sit with the customers and we bought them drinks, usually colored water at inflated prices. I guess one idea was to get the customer drunk and on his way, and then move to the next one. This young girl seemed quite innocent to me and cute. Maybe I was the innocent one. Her name was Tomiko Yamashita and I think she was not a prostitute. I met her mother. We went to a resort for a weekend. I was not serious about a long term relationship; at the time I thought that marriage between different ethnic groups was not appropriate, at least not for me. Today I have two Korean grandchildren and inter-racial marriage is acceptable in many circles. I think she would have jumped at the chance to come to the US but that

⁹Lieutenant, junior grade

was not my intent, and I never led her to believe it was. In any case, I decided that she would be better off not working in a bar, and I helped her get a job at the Navy Exchange on the Navy Base. We exchanged letters after I left Japan.



Dick with Tomiko and her mother

All Navy ships visited Yokosuka upon arrival in Japan . It's a major US Naval Base and the city caters to the needs and wants of sailors. There are lots of bars, massage parlors, tailors and the like. The Navy Exchange carried electronics, china and Asian clothing and such. I bought tailor made suits, stereo systems and Noritake china at prices I couldn't pass by. In 1961 the US dollar was worth 360 yen so things were quite inexpensive. Today the rate is something like 48 yen to the dollar which makes things very expensive.

We spent Christmas, 1961 in Kobe, Japan. We had a group of children aboard, I think they were orphans. We gave them presents, cake, cookies and drink. During that visit, I had a Kobe steak for dinner. It wasn't expensive since the exchange rate was so favorable. When we visited in 2012, the cost of a

Kobe steak dinner was at least \$100 per person.

The ship also visited Hong Kong while it was still a British colony. We visited all the tourist places and purchased stuff for very reasonable prices since the exchange rate was very favorable for the American dollar. My favorite purchase was a Leak stereo system and sand filled Wharfdale speakers; Diana still has and is using the speakers today. I also bought a tailor made suit, shirts, dresses for my mother and Aunt Marguerite, Suzie Wong dresses for Edy, Joyce and Peggy, and more. I transported all this stuff back to NH in my boat when I went back for submarine school.

You may recall “the Maddox incident” off the coast of South Vietnam in August 1964 in the Gulf of Tonkin. She was involved in a skirmish with North Vietnamese torpedo boats, which led to increased U.S. involvement in the Vietnam War. This was after I left the ship.

Submarine School

At the beginning of 1962 I applied to Submarine School in New London, CT and was accepted for the class beginning in April. My motivation to get into the Submarine Service was the chance to serve on another type of ship, extra pay for hazardous duty, and also to be near home in NH for the summer. I wanted to spend some time with my parents, use my boat on Lake Winnepesaukee and maybe meet a nice New England girl. The women I met in California I was not much attracted to or perhaps they were not attracted to me. I left Long Beach in March 1962 in my '58 Chevy and headed for Beaufort, SC to visit my sister and her family. She was married to a Marine Officer stationed at Camp Lejeune and had a baby boy about six months old. Larry Joseph, Jr. or LJ, was born while I was deployed in WestPac. He was the first child of a new generation in our family. He was born about nine months after the wedding I attended in DC the Christmas of 1960.

After leaving Long Beach, I made it to West Texas the first night, about 800 miles, and slept in the car on the outskirts of El Paso. It was late and I didn't want to spend money on a motel for just a few hours. The second night I got to eastern Texas, another 800 miles or so, and stayed in a hotel with a bathtub; I enjoyed a good soak and a good night's rest. The third day I drove another 700 miles or so, stayed in a motel, left early and arrived at my sister's place in the afternoon of the fourth day, having traveled about 2800 miles in four days. I didn't see much other than the road, gas stations and a few McDonalds, but I



Larry, Jr. (LJ) as a baby

enjoyed being in my car on a great American highway.

After arriving at my sister's in SC, I spent the rest of the day visiting and playing with the baby, stayed the night, and left for NH in the morning. I drove as far as Newark, NJ and stayed at a small hotel in the city. I parked the car in a well-lighted spot and was happy to see it in the morning just as I had left it. Packed with stereo equipment, Noritake China, tailored suits and gifts from the Far East, it might have been a good target for thieves.

It was good to be back home in NH the next day. The first thing I wanted to eat was fried clams which I hadn't had in California. They are native to the East Coast. Everything else that I cared to eat was available in California.

At Submarine School in New London, CT we bachelor officers were assigned single rooms in the BOQ (Bachelor Officer's Quarters). It was much like a motel room, comfortable but Spartan. We ate most of our meals in the dining hall since they were included in our program. There was also a MOQ (Married Officer's Quarters) where married students lived with their families. It was nicknamed "fertility flats"; a train went by early in the morning, waking people up, too early to get up

but too late to go back to sleep.

The academic program concentrated on submarine systems: main propulsion, diesel engines, electric motors and generators; auxiliary systems, HP air compressor, low pressure air pump, auxiliary generators, tanks, air systems, snorkel, periscopes and more. We also learned to maneuver a submarine on the surface, navigating at sea and bringing it alongside the pier. We learned to dive from the surface to various depths underwater, such as periscope depth or 100 feet, and to act as diving officer controlling the submarine's depth by directing the actions of the planesmen.

We attended class Monday through Friday from 8AM to 4PM, and were free from after class on Friday until start of class on Monday. This was when the rest of my plan came into being: using my boat on Lake Winnepesaukee and maybe meeting a nice young woman from NH or New England. Leaving New London at 4PM, I was able to drive home to NH in about 3 hours or less. We didn't have homework to do on the weekend.

I initially stayed with my father at his home in Winnisquam which was not far from Laconia where I grew up. My parents were divorced and my father lived alone in a little house he inherited from his sister, my Aunt Helen. My mother remarried and lived in Florida, but she received the family home in Lakeport in the divorce settlement and came home each summer. So I stayed with her and her husband, Ben, part of the time.

Aunt Marguerite, Uncle Bud, cousins Joyce and Peggy, and Grandmother Mack lived in Laconia. So, except for my sister in SC, the whole family was home. Marguerite and Bud had a summer cottage on Lake Winnepesaukee which I enjoyed going to in my boat. It was on the far side of the Lake from where I kept the boat in Lakeport, maybe 10 miles away. We all enjoyed water skiing from the boat as well as cookouts and such at the camp.

I asked my cousin Joyce if she knew of any young women I could date, and she mentioned Sue Lindsey. Joyce was best friends with Sue who I knew slightly from high school. She was



Zaida and her second husband, Ben, in Florida

three years behind me so we had little contact in school. Joyce arranged a date and we hit it off quite well.

After about three months of the six month Submarine School program, the Navy gave us per diem which meant we could move out of the BOQ and rent a house in town. Four of us got together and rented the home of a Navy Commander who would be away for three months. Later we found out he was the captain of a nuclear submarine that was going under the Arctic ice at the top of the world, one of the first if not the first submarine to do so, in July 1962.

Sue came down to New London for a weekend and stayed with us in the rented house. She slept in my bed and I slept on the sofa; it was a different time with different customs in 1962, or maybe we were old fashioned. She drove her Austin Healy Sprite, and we went to the ocean beach on Long Island Sound. She probably arrived Saturday and left Sunday so there wasn't a lot of time to do much. We dated on the weekends when I went home and enjoyed the boat on Lake Winnepesaukee, water



cousin Joyce (left) and Sue Lindsey (right)

skiing and such.



Sue and Dick with the waterskiing boat

In September 1962 I graduated from Sub School high enough in the class to get assigned to a submarine in San Diego. I'm a warm water sailor, no North Atlantic winters for me. I reported

to USS CAIMAN (SS 323) in October 1962. Sue flew out to San Diego after Christmas. Her father gave her a return plane ticket to NH in case things didn't work out. That's another story.

Duty on USS CAIMAN (SS 323)

After Submarine School I drove across the country from New Hampshire to San Diego to report for duty on my new ship, USS CAIMAN (SS 323). CAIMAN was a WW II diesel electric fleet type submarine built at Electric Boat Company in Groton, CT and launched 30 March 1944. It was upgraded in 1951 and 1961 to the configuration I found when I reported aboard in October 1962, a Guppy II submarine.

In the spring of 1951 she was converted from a standard fleet type to a streamlined 'guppy' submarine at Mare Island Naval Shipyard in Vallejo, California. 'Guppy' stands for 'Greater Underwater Propulsion Power'. She was outfitted with a 'snorkel' which is a breathing device that permits diesel electric submarines to take in and exhaust air while operating submerged. This allowed her to charge batteries while submerged thus allowing her to operate submerged for long periods of time. The conversion also included installing high capacity electric storage batteries and streamlining her hull and sail.

In January 1961 CAIMAN went into Hunters Point Naval Shipyard, San Francisco for a six month overhaul. During this overhaul the step sail was replaced with a tall fiberglass sail and the after deck was replaced with fiberglass hinged clamshells. This information came from Wikipedia and I included it to give readers an appreciation for the upgrades from the WWII



The USS CAIMAN in the 1950s

submarine to the submarines of the 50s, 60s and 70s prior to and during the development and introduction of the nuclear submarine.

CAIMAN was tied up alongside the submarine tender USS PROTEUS (AS 19) at the submarine base on Point Loma in San Diego when I reported aboard in October 1962. It was doing local operations in the San Diego area, which means it usually went to sea on Monday morning and returned on Friday afternoon. The Captain was LCDR John Bilderback, Class of '48, USNA, the Executive Officer was LCDR Bill _____, USC, Operations Officer was LT Tom Jacobs, Class of '58, USNA, Engineer was LT Rod Johnston, Class of '59, USNA, Communications Officer was LT Len Santos. There were three LT(jg)'s of which I was one. The others were Qualified in Submarines.

A major task for an Officer or enlisted sailor reporting aboard a submarine is qualification, which is a year-long process of getting familiar with all the submarine systems and operations. We had to complete a notebook we received at the

end of sub school covering all aspects of submarine systems and operations. We had to diagram all the piping, electrical, high pressure and low pressure air systems, and hydraulic systems.

We qualified as diving officers responsible for operation of the forward and after planes, high and low pressure air systems and the control room. We were supposed to qualify as conning officer including making torpedo attacks on other ships. It was not part of my training on CAIMAN and, as a result, I did not pass qualification the first time around. After that the Captain arranged for me to qualify on a second submarine in our squadron and I was able to pass. In hindsight I should have been more assertive and insisted on making at least a couple of attacks before going up for qualification.

Duty on a submarine

Submarine duty is special and the people assigned to submarines are special as well. It is known as the “silent service” because the greatest weapon a submarine possesses is its ability to go places silently and undetected. While traveling submerged, the battery supplies power and all systems are in quiet mode. The sonar system is nearly always in passive mode, listening to sounds underwater but not sending out any electronic sounds or “pings” that might be detected by a surface ship or another submarine also listening.

Being underwater has the advantage of stealth. It has the disadvantage that a casualty in the hull or to valves open to the sea can cause the submarine to flood very quickly and sink. Therefore, every Officer and sailor must learn all the systems on the submarine, and be able to take proper action in the event of a casualty to prevent or quickly stop flooding.

The process of learning the systems and procedures is called qualification and usually takes about a year of study and practical experience aboard a submarine, followed by an examination. When the person completes the year of study and practical experience, and passes the exam, he is authorized to

wear “dolphins”, a pin on his uniform showing he is “Qualified in Submarines.” It’s a great feeling of accomplishment to be able to wear the dolphins.



A homemade plaque with some of Dick’s Navy pins, including dolphins at the top and bottom. The double bars denote the rank of Lieutenant; the single bars denote an Ensign.

My daily routine at sea during the first year consisted of standing two 4-hour watches, working on qualification and assigned duties for 8 hours and eating and sleeping for 8 hours. I usually slept during the day and worked during the night; since you can’t see out of the interior of the submarine you can’t tell whether it’s day or night. I pretty much had the wardroom to myself during the night, and it was easy to trace

submarine systems when most people were in bed.

Speaking of bed, the officer's stateroom consisted of six bunks, three high and two end to end. If you got into your bunk on your back, that's how you stayed; there was not enough clearance to roll over. Since space is limited some sailors have to "hot bunk"; share a bunk with another sailor, not at the same time. When one man is on watch, the other is sleeping, so the bunk never cools off. I hot bunked on the Sub School cruise to Bermuda. As an Officer, I had my own bunk. The newer nuclear submarines are much larger and provide many more amenities. Each person has his own bunk, with reading light and locker for clothes and personal items. The Officers probably have single or double staterooms.

A diesel electric submarine is equally adept at both surface and submerged operations. The shape of the hull is much like a surface ship, with the added capability of submerging. Many WWII submarine operations were a combination of a surface approach on an enemy warship or freighter, then submerging at the last minute to elude any attacking ships or planes. The submarine captain can see more clearly on the surface and make more informed decisions. Newer nuclear submarines, with their teardrop shape, are designed mostly for submerged operations and spend as little time on the surface as possible.

Standing watch submerged consisted of being diving officer. The diving officer supervises the planes men who control angles of the bow and stem planes and therefore the attitude and depth of the submarine. Depth control is most critical when at periscope depth and especially when snorkeling. The goal is to maintain periscope depth so the periscope is just slightly out of the water. If it goes underwater the conning officer can't see, and if it goes too far out of the water it makes a bigger target for detection by ships and aircraft, and the submarine may be in danger of broaching.

A submarine snorkels when it is under water running on the diesel engines and charging the batteries. When snorkeling, the snorkel head needs to be out of the water just far enough to bring in fresh air. If it is too far out of the water it increases

the probability of detection, like the periscope. If the snorkel goes under water, the snorkel valve closes preventing water from entering the submarine, but also shutting off the source of air for the engines. At that time the engines draw air out of the submarine, making a vacuum in the boat. At a preset vacuum level, the engines shut down and power is shifted to the battery. Then, after depth control is regained, the snorkel valve opens and the process of restarting the engines and setting up the battery charge is repeated. In addition, everybody's ears are affected, first by the vacuum, then when the snorkel valve opens and pressure is suddenly back to sea level. Ear drums can burst. Sleeping sailors awaken suddenly. This is not, as they say in Maine, the way life should be!

How a submarine works

Standing watch on the surface as AOOD (Assistant Officer of the Deck) is comprised of being on the bridge with two lookouts watching for other ships and any other traffic in the area. The OOD (Officer of the Deck) is usually in the conning tower looking around with the periscope, navigating and staying abreast of the tactical situation and the operation of the ship. He, as well as the captain, may come to the bridge at any time to take a look around, get some fresh air, talk to the AOOD or assume control from the bridge.

The most exciting time on the bridge is when the OOD or the captain gives the order to submerge, usually "take her down." At that point the AOOD yells, "clear the bridge, clear the bridge," "dive, dive," sounds two blasts on the claxton, "aooga, aooga," the lookouts go down the hatch followed by the AOOD who secures the hatch at the top of the conning tower and goes below to the control room to take his post as diving officer. The first thing he looks for and reports is, "green board," which means all hatches and valves open to the sea are closed.

Buoyancy is one of the more basic physical principles. At its simplest, it may be explained in this way. When you put

an object in water, it will displace some of the water. If the object's weight is less than or equal to the weight of the water it displaces it will float. If it weighs more than the displaced water it will sink. A submarine works by being able to vary its displacement. Most of the time the ballast tanks are kept full of air, which makes the sub lighter than the water it displaces. In this instance, the boat is surfaced, with the air in the main ballast tanks is holding the boat on the surface.

To submerge, the crew opens vents at the top of the ballast tanks. This lets the air out. The bottom of the ballast tank is open to the sea, so as soon as the air is released water comes in to take its place, the displacement increases, and the boat slips below the surface.

Submarines are designed so that, with the main ballast tanks full, the weight of water they displace will be as close as possible to exactly equal to the weight of the boat. In practice, the boat should retain a slight amount of positive buoyancy, so that it will want to slowly rise to the surface if nothing else acts to keep it under.

In diving quickly, the negative tank is important. By flooding this tank the submarine becomes negatively buoyant. This gets the boat under water quicker. Once submerged, though, the negative tank will be blown or pumped out, to restore neutral buoyancy. You want to be heavier than water as you dive, but you don't want to stay that way once you're under. If the negative tank remained full and all power was lost the boat would quickly sink below crush depth and kill everyone aboard.

The safety tank, which is normally kept fully flooded while submerged, is designed to hold the same volume of water as the conning tower. If the conning tower floods and has to be abandoned, the safety tank may be blown dry to compensate.

Buoyancy and trim tanks are used to adjust the centre of balance of the submerged submarine. By pumping air and water back and forth between them, the diving officer can balance the boat. Water can freely flow in and out of these area, but has no affect on displacement. The superstructure is made free flooding

to avoid air pockets that can affect trim, or potentially release a cloud of bubbles that might give away the boat's position.

So now you know how a submarine works!

CAIMAN Deploys to WestPac

The Cuban Missile Crisis occurred in October 1962, shortly after I reported aboard USS CAIMAN from Sub School. We were put on alert in case of the outbreak of war but fortunately that didn't happen. With the crisis averted we went back to operations as usual.

We were scheduled to operate out of San Diego for several months until our deployment to WestPac. As it turned out, another submarine was scheduled to deploy at that time, but had some serious mechanical difficulties, and CAIMAN was selected to go in its place. The timing was a little unfortunate since my girlfriend, Sue, was moving to San Diego from NH. Sue arrived in San Diego, found an apartment and got a job in a department store shortly after that I left for WestPac.

The Navy gave us a few weeks to prepare for our six-month deployment to WestPac. One of the things we did was load up the ship with dozens of 5-gallon cans of lube oil. Our four GM V-16 diesel engines were a little tired and in need of work but we were deemed fit for deployment. During the deployment, the enginemen overhauled one or more of the engines. There was an instance when we made an unscheduled stop on the northern Japanese island of Hokkaido to buy a part for one of the engines. The engines were similar to those used in railroad engines so many of the parts were interchangeable.

Diesel submarines traveled on the surface most of the time while transiting long distances. The ship simply went faster and more economically on the surface. We could charge the batteries and cruise along without snorkeling. Every day or so we submerged, just to stay sharp, practice maneuvers and check all the underwater systems. Then we'd surface and resume our transit.

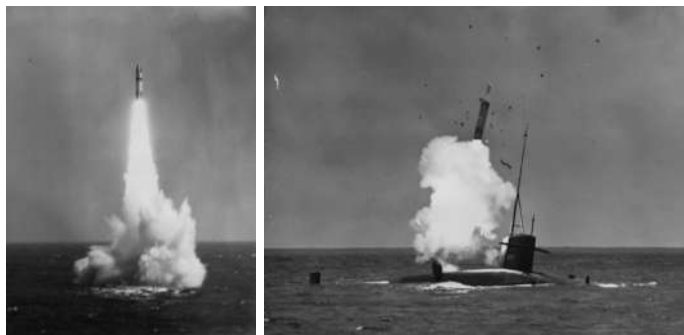
Half way across the Pacific is Hawaii, with the Navy base at Pearl Harbor. Most Navy ships in the Pacific stop in Pearl for a few days, for R&R, supplies and any maintenance needed. There is a submarine repair facility on the Navy base with a BOQ and barracks, so we could get off the submarine for a few nights and days. Liberty in Oahu is a very nice.

From Pearl Harbor we headed for Japan. Our speed across the Pacific was 8–10 knots, which sounds slow. But since we travel 24/7, the miles slip away: 214 a day, 2140 in ten days. We met up with Navy surface ships along the way and did ASW (anti-submarine warfare) exercises. Then we arrived in Yokosuka, Japan where there is another Navy base. There is also a BOQ called the “submarine haven,” just for submarine officers. It’s a place to hang out, take a shower, drink beer and sleep off the ship.

A submarine like CAIMAN has a very limited capability to make and store fresh water. As a result, submariners are limited to one Navy shower per week. A Navy shower consists of wetting down, turning off the water, soaping down, and then rinsing. Only one or two gallons of water per shower are used. We still take Navy showers to conserve fresh water.

During our six months in WestPac we conducted ASW operations with Navy surface ships and independent operations as well. On one occasion we traveled independently to the vicinity of the Kamchatka Peninsula. This was during the Cold War. Our mission was to witness and photograph the test launch of a Russian missile. We had to make it into a Russian harbor with warships all around, take our pictures through the periscope and get out of there undetected. If discovered and sunk the US Government would claim no knowledge of our whereabouts. We did it.

This was an instance where we were submerged for a period of four weeks, I think. We would run slowly on the battery during the day, to conserve the battery, then snorkel to charge the batteries during the night. This was the real thing, not a war game, week after week until the mission was over. This was highly classified for many years but no longer is.



A missile launch, with CAIMAN 323 in the foreground

Deploying to WestPac has its good side. We visited ports in Japan, Hong Kong, Philippines and Okinawa. We had hoped to visit Australia but that didn't happen. The story was that Australian girls really like American sailors. Actually it seemed that most girls in foreign ports like American sailors.

CAIMAN in WestPac II

In 1962 I saw no evidence in Japan of the destruction from WWII, except the memorial in Nagasaki to the atom bomb. I saw no resentment among the people toward Americans; actually most people were friendly and thankful for our efforts after the war to help the nation rise from the depths of defeat. It wasn't until very recently that I remembered or realized the torture American prisoners were subjected to in Japanese prisoner of war camps.

The book *Unbroken* by Laura Hillenbrand depicts Olympic runner Louie Zamperini's experiences in prison camps during WWII. I think the Japanese people understood that there was enough blame to go around for all the destruction and death that happened on both sides during the war.

It was interesting to visit Japanese cities like the ancient capital, Kyoto, as well as Osaka, Sasebo, Tokyo, various shrines



Dick (back row, second from right) in Japan

and gardens, attend a Japanese tea ceremony, shows and movies. I remember with fondness a real Japanese meal cooked at our table with a gas fired hibachi while sitting on pillows on the floor with a quilt over our legs and a charcoal fire under the table. It was winter. Japan was becoming somewhat westernized in dress especially the younger people, but there was still much of the ancient culture in evidence; women wearing kimonos, geisha and the like. To a young man it was fascinating.

While the ship was in port we usually stood watch one day on and two days off, or sometimes, one day on and three days off. This allowed us to spend time ashore and visit interesting places. Usually the officers traveled in groups of two or more, depending on who was interested in seeing what.

While on duty in port we had just enough people on board to maintain security and take care of the ship. I spent a lot of time working on my qualification notebook, making diagrams of

all the ship's systems and learning about submarine operations. I was able to complete most of the notebook during the WestPac cruise.

In my tour of duty aboard the destroyer USS MADDOX (DD731) from Aug 1960 to March 1962 we also deployed to WestPac. During a visit to Sasebo in 1961, I met a Japanese girl named Tomiko in a bar. After I left Sasebo, we wrote letters until I returned on CAIMAN a couple of years later. She was still working at the Navy Exchange, the job I helped her to get. When I left Sasebo the second time it was the last time I saw Tomiko. My girlfriend [Sue] in San Diego was not pleased with my friendship with Tomiko, so that ended.

Another port we visited was Hong Kong, when it was still a British territory. We climbed the mountain which overlooks Hong Kong harbor and took the ferry across Victoria Harbor to Macao. We visited Kowloon, a city where most people live on boats in the harbor, and had dinner at a floating restaurant which we got to by small boat. A man or woman using an oar in the stern propelled the boat by sculling. We were able to select a fish swimming in a tank to have prepared for dinner. Seaweed was always served with the entree. A unique thing about visiting Hong Kong was that, in exchange for giving away our garbage, people would paint the sides of our ship while we were at anchor. We provided the paint. This was the place to purchase tailor made suits and shirts, which we all got one or more of. Only recently did I finally give those suits to local clothes closet, a charity that provides clothes to needy people.

In 1962 the US dollar was very strong and valuable. I remember that the exchange rate was 360 yen to the dollar; today it is something like 48 yen to the dollar. I don't remember the exchange rate for the Hong Kong dollar but it was favorable because tailor made suits were quite inexpensive by our standards. The diamond engagement ring I bought in Hong Kong was less expensive than at home mainly because the cost of the platinum setting was less. The cost of diamonds was pretty much the same worldwide.

Sometime after that, when our tour in WestPac was

winding down, I received orders to report to Admiral Rickover in Washington, DC to interview for the nuclear power program. So I flew from Yokosuka, Japan to DC. On the way back, I was to meet the ship in Pearl Harbor but I stopped in San Diego to see Sue. It was during this time that we were engaged. Then I flew to Pearl and met the ship for the transit to San Diego. When we arrived back in the states we had been deployed about six months. It's always good to get back home!

Home in San Diego

After the WestPac tour we were scheduled to be home in San Diego for a while before leaving again. Before Christmas 1963, Sue flew back to New Hampshire to plan our wedding. A few days before the scheduled date, December 21, 1963, I also flew back. But I didn't fly commercial, I flew space available on military flights. The basic philosophy was to get on any flight flying in the general direction you were going. I left San Diego, flew to Little Rock, AR. then to Dayton, OH where I spent the night in the BOQ (Bachelor Officer's Quarters). In the morning, I got a flight to Manchester, NH, just an hour's ride by car to Laconia. In hindsight it was a little gutsy to take the chance of being late to my own wedding but it worked out.



Dick and Sue's wedding

Our wedding took place in the Unitarian Church in Laconia.



Married!

My mother flew up from Florida for the occasion; Edy came from Beaufort, SC. And my father, living in Winnisquam, NH also attended. My friend, Doug Watts, was best man, and Ted Lindsey and Andy Johnson were ushers. Nancy Lindsey was matron of honor and Edy was one of the bridesmaids. We had a big cake and we used my Navy sword to cut it, ceremoniously, at least.



Edy as a bridesmaid, with other bridesmaids and groomsmen

We held the reception at Sue's parents' home at Woodwinds,

Weirs Beach, NH.



At the reception: Sarah Mack; Zaida and Marguerite

We decided to drive Sue's Austin Healy Sprite 2 seater sports car back to San Diego so she could use it and we'd have a second car there. I still had my 1958 Chevy Impala convertible. After the reception we left in the Sprite for the trip to San Diego. I had to be back aboard ship by December 29, which gave us six days for the 3000 mile plus trip. Not much room for error and not much of a honeymoon! The first night we got to Hartford, CT. We headed south to try to reach warm weather and better travel conditions. In North Carolina we woke up to ice covered roads after a night of freezing rain. We drove with two wheels on the pavement and two on the dirt shoulder to maintain some traction. Another night, further west, I put a six-pack of beer in the frozen swimming pool to keep it cold. Eventually we encountered warmer temps and made it back to the ship on time. In retrospect, the date I had to be back was arbitrary and not a great incentive to stay in the Navy.

We found a small, furnished apartment in San Diego near Point Loma which is where the submarine tied up, alongside the submarine tender at the submarine base. The tender was a very large ship having capabilities to repair and replace most submarine systems, like a small, compact shipyard. It was a



Sue with her Austin Healy Sprite 2-seater sports car

short way to go to work while we were in port, and a nice area in which to live. I suspect we signed a year's lease but broke it early when the ship went to San Francisco for overhaul at the San Francisco Naval Shipyard. There is a public law that states that service people ordered to different duty stations can break a lease without penalty. We rented a U-Haul type covered trailer in San Diego to transport our stuff to San Francisco, and drove up Coastal Route 99, stopping at the Hearst Castle at San Simeon, CA.

In San Francisco we lived in a WWII Quonset Hut that we thought was great. It wasn't so much that the house was great but that the cost was low, leaving most of our paycheck for other things, and it was within walking distance of the ship. We explored the San Francisco area, spent time at Fisherman's Wharf, and explored The Presidio, North Beach and the city. We had dinner at a pizza place where we ordered pizza with anchovies, thinking anchovies were some sort of vegetable. I remember the anchovies were quite salty, and not what we



A Quonset Hut

had expected. I think I haven't ordered anchovies since. One weekend we drove north to the area of big Humboldt redwood trees, and set up our tent off the road in a little area not intended for camping. We bought a slab of redwood from which we made a coffee table; it's still in the family currently residing in Colorado with daughter, Karen, and family.

I was concerned about my mother, and decided to drive from San Francisco to Miami to see how she was doing. She flew to NH from FL for the wedding, arriving just a day or so before. I didn't get to spend much time with her. After the wedding she had to get back to Boston to get a plane back to Miami. I felt badly that I wasn't there to help.

We took the '58 Chevy convertible and drove directly to Miami. I remember two things about the trip to Miami: Sue thought I would look good smoking a pipe, so I tried smoking a pipe. It was hot on my tongue and not pleasant at all, so that was the end of that. The other thing was we stopped for the night in what had once been a state park but no longer was. We set up the tent and went to bed. In the middle of the night we heard something rubbing against the outside of the tent. Sue said, "Dick, get up and see what's rubbing against the tent." I got up to check and found wild ponies running around in the

campsite. I think we tried to sleep but ultimately gave up and got back on the road, at maybe 4 AM. We stopped for breakfast at a little restaurant where I had grits for the first time in my life.

We got to Miami safely and spent a few days with Mother and Ben. They gave us the master bedroom since we were still sort of honeymooning. I changed the oil and filter in the car for the trip back to San Francisco; at that time we were changing the oil every thousand miles or so.



Zaida, Dick and Ben in Florida

On the way back we decided to stop in Grand Canyon. Before we got there, in Albuquerque, NM, the car started to lose power and the engine was not running properly. I stopped and adjusted the timing but couldn't make it right. We continued on to Grand Canyon where we set up our tent, and I decided to take off the valve cover. What I found was emulsified oil, indicating that water was mixing with the oil; not a good sign.

Fortunately there is a garage in the Grand Canyon that works on cars; they diagnosed a burned valve seat requiring a new or rebuilt cylinder head and valve assembly. They located a rebuilt head in Flagstaff, NM; all we had to do was get to Flagstaff, pick it up and bring it back to Grand Canyon. For reasons I cannot remember, Sue went there to get the cylinder head with a man from the garage, and brought it back. It was from an older Chevy which had a different temperature sensor, so our temperature gauge didn't work after that. But the car ran fine and we were on our way in another day.

While in San Diego I met Gwen & Bill Nelson. Bill was from Laconia originally and I was introduced to the Nelsons by Bill's sister who still lived in Lakeport. Bill & Gwen mentioned that a friend of theirs had a house he wanted to sell in Claremont, a part of San Diego; all I needed to do was take over the mortgage payments. I did that and was the owner of a 3 bedroom house. Sue and I moved in for a few months, until I received orders to Washington, DC. Before we left I rented the house to John Donaldson, a fellow officer on CAIMAN, and his family who stayed in the house for a year or so. We ultimately sold the house and realized a few thousand dollars which we used to purchase a 27' Chris Craft Cavalier motor boat to use on Lake Winnepesaukee.



The Chris Craft Cavalier

Sue and Dick to Washington, DC

Before we left San Diego Sue's younger brother, Steve, flew out to see us, to experience a little of California and drive back with us. Steve was younger than Sue and their siblings, maybe ten years younger, one of those surprise babies who shows up unexpectedly. In any case, this was to be a grand adventure for Steve.



Steve (left) with Scott, a few years later

One weekend after we returned to San Diego we purchased a new car, my first new one. It was a fire engine red 1964 Valiant with a white vinyl hardtop, V-8 engine and Hurst four on the floor transmission. I was kind of sad to trade in my 1958 Chevrolet Impala convertible but it had about 100,000 miles on it; in the 60s, 100,000 miles was about what a car was designed to go, and it also had the reconditioned cylinder head, replaced with an older model so the temperature gauge didn't work. We sold Sue's Austin Healy Sprite and turned the Chevy in on the new Valiant. So we had a new car for this trip across the country.



The '64 Valiant, after a fender bender

I think Sue was instrumental in the decision to purchase a new car, being the daughter of a man who traded for a new car every year, sometimes twice in the same year. She has been known to remark, in all seriousness, "I just love that new car smell." Today we can place a new car smell tree in any car and enjoy that new car smell forever. I like to buy a two year old car with under 30,000 miles, coming off lease, and drive it as long as it is reliable, which has worked well for us.

It was September and the weather was warm and beautiful. We had our camping equipment and planned to use the tent along the way whenever we could. I think we got to Yellowstone National Park in a couple of days and set up the tent in the campground. I had moved up from tenting in a turnoff on the side of the road. All was well during the night, no bears or wild ponies rubbing against the tent, but we awoke to a winter wonderland. Everything was covered with a couple of inches of snow. From warm and beautiful Southern California to snow in two days!

The snow didn't last long and we worked our way along the northern part of the country, through the badlands of South Dakota, Mount Rushmore, and on to Detroit. We took a tour through the Ford Rouge Plant where Great Lakes ore carriers offload iron ore on one side of the campus and finished cars drive out the other side. On the way to Maine this spring [2010?] we plan to revisit the Rouge plant and see if the new Fords start out as ore and drive out the door.

In September 1964 we witnessed the all new 1964 Ford Mustangs being assembled and driven out the door. I kind of wished we had waited and considered buying a new Mustang but that was water over the dam. The Valiant was a good car for a few years. Sue's father actually purchased a new 1964 Mustang for her mother to drive to school where she was a teacher. It must have been in the winter when she skidded off the road and totaled the car. I don't think she was hurt in the accident. So much for a Mustang in the family.

We arrived in New Hampshire and spent a couple of weeks visiting and relaxing; I think I had 30 days leave between duty stations. Then we drove to DC to find a place to live.

My Work at Strategic Systems Project Office, II

As a Navy LT in DC, most officers were Captains, so I was accepted as an important member of the team, which designed and built a portion of the Fleet Ballistic Missile submarine weapon system. Initially we built the Polaris system and then upgraded to the Poseidon system. The Polaris missile was gradually replaced on 31 of the 41 original SSBNs (nuclear submarines with ballistic missiles) in the Navy by Poseidon missiles with MIRV (multiple independently targeted reentry vehicles) beginning in 1972. During the time I was there we supported the deployed Polaris systems and began development of the new Poseidon missile and associated systems.

In SSPO Naval Officers wore uniforms every day. In most other assignments in DC, Naval Officers wore civilian clothes every day or every day but one each week. My first assignment was to plan, schedule and deliver our TI (test instrumentation) systems to shipyards for installation in submarines coming in for overhaul. I had a big chart on the wall of my office with horizontal lines showing where each of our TI systems was currently and where it was scheduled to go. Each month a photographer would come and take a picture of my chart, and we'd send it out to everybody who needed to know the whereabouts of our systems.

What I actually did, in addition to maintaining the big chart, was tell our contractor, IEC (Interstate Electronics

Corporation) to pick up a TI system at one shipyard and ship it by air-ride truck to the next shipyard. IEC has test engineers at all the shipyards. When our systems arrived at a shipyard, IEC people would install it in the submarine coming into overhaul, and do the testing under the direction of Navy people. When testing was complete the IEC test engineers would uninstall the TI system and load it into a truck for delivery to next shipyard.

That's how things worked at SSPO; we managed the program but we paid contractors to do the work. It worked well then and it continues to work well. There was a close relationship among Naval Officers, Navy civilian employees and contractor personnel. Just about every month I flew to Los Angeles, rented a car and drove to Anaheim to meet with contractor people at their plant. Contractor people also flew to Washington to meet with us in our office. We sometimes had "working lunches" with the contractor at nice restaurants in DC, with the contractor picking up the tab. I felt uncomfortable doing this knowing that the cost was ultimately charged to a contract, and to the taxpayers.

In the mid-60s, flying was still fun. I'd drive to Dulles Airport outside Washington early Monday morning, get on a plane, have a lovely lunch in economy, and arrive at LAX around 2 in the afternoon. I'd get to stay at a nice motel near Disneyland and eat at a good restaurant on my per diem. Occasionally we'd have a "working dinner" at a restaurant in the area, usually one on one with my counterpart at IEC, charged to a contract. It did foster a good working relationship, at least that's how I rationalized it. After three days with the contractor, I flew back to DC, either on the "red eye" on Thursday night, arriving around eight AM, or on a Friday morning flight arriving late afternoon, too late to go to work.

Before long I took on additional responsibilities. Once a system is deployed it has to be supported. Wherever the system is there needs to be stocks of spare parts with which to repair a system when it fails to function properly. I became the person responsible for reviewing the contractor's recommended list of spare parts, and making decisions on which parts needed to be

stocked in which locations. Tens or hundreds of thousands of dollars worth of parts were stocked at several locations so it was an important job. We usually had these provisioning conferences at the contractor's plant in Anaheim.

We lived on Schellhorn Drive in Alexandria, VA for our first two and a half years working in DC. I was able to take a car to the bus stop and take the bus to Constitution Avenue where I worked. I did the reverse to get home. Scott was born on August 7, 1965 at the Fort Belvoir Army Hospital, the closest military hospital to our home. His was a natural birth which was how they did it in military hospitals at that time. He was our first child and Sue had a long, difficult labor. She went into labor in the early evening and Scott was finally born the following morning. Nobody had prepared me so when I first saw Scott with his elongated head I thought I had become the father of a special needs child. I was destined to spend my life in the Navy so Scott would receive whatever medical services he needed. Fortunately it didn't turn out that way.



Dick and Sue with baby Scott



Baby Scott

Robert McNamara was Secretary of Defense from 1961 to 1968, under presidents Kennedy and Johnson. In the mid-1960s, during the Viet Nam War, he decided that many of the jobs performed by military people in DC could just as well be performed by civilians, freeing up the military to do jobs that civilians could not. I surely didn't agree with all of McNamara's decisions but I agreed with that one, especially as it pertained to my job. I had decided to leave active duty Navy and become a civilian. I was doing a good job in SSPO and my superiors, both military and civilian, supported me and helped me convert my job to civil service and me to a civilian Engineer, GS12. Navy LT is equivalent to GS12. So one day I showed up in uniform and the next day in civilian clothes. It was a seamless transition.

About that time we decided to purchase a house in Annapolis, MD. Annapolis is on the Severn River near the Chesapeake Bay, and sailing is great! We found a new home at 108 Melvin Avenue in West Annapolis, a Dutch colonial with three bedrooms and one and a half baths. We could walk to the Severn River. It was going to be great! I spent four



Three generations: Granddad (Bob), Scott, and Dick

years at the Naval Academy in Annapolis, from 1956 to 1960, but spent very little time in town. The idea of living there as a civilian was attractive. It was hot and humid in DC and Alexandria, and I sensed a drop in temperature and humidity as I approached Annapolis on the way home from work. I bought an old 27' wooden Alden sloop and fixed it up. We had some wonderful sails on the Severn River and Chesapeake Bay.

Getting to work was more of a challenge, a 45 minute plus commute with lots of traffic, lots of traffic lights and no place to park. For a while I was able to car pool with a Navy Captain who lived close by, worked for Admiral Rickover and had a parking place. When he transferred I found other car pools and made it to work but it became a hassle after a couple of years.

During our time in Annapolis Karen was born; September 18, 1967. This time Sue went to the Annapolis city hospital and received appropriate medications to make the pain tolerable, a method she much preferred. Life as a civilian was good.



The house in Annapolis

Mental Illness in My Family II

In 1967, I was married with two children, living in Annapolis, MD. I got a call from Ben Schreiber, my step father, that my mother, in Florida, was having problems and needed to visit us to help resolve these problems. So she flew up to Reagan National Airport in Washington, DC where we met her in the airport.

It was dark when she arrived; she was escorted off the plane by a flight attendant, in a wheel chair, as I recall. We helped her into the car and started back to Annapolis. On the trip from DC to Annapolis, riding in the back seat of our car, she imagined demons coming at her; they were the oncoming headlights of cars coming toward us in the other lane. When we got home we gave her the guest bedroom. During the night she wandered



Scott with baby Karen



The family with baby Karen

around looking in at us, presumably making sure we were all okay. We heard her walking around and thought it strange. I got up and helped her back to bed but she didn't stay there long. She got up and wandered around some more.

Next door to us lived a Navy doctor who was a friend and, in the morning, I asked him to look at and talk to Mother, and



Zaida and Ben Schreiber

give me his prognosis. He said she was an emergency case of extreme mental illness. So she was seen by a psychiatrist and admitted to a Maryland State Hospital outside of Annapolis. When I visited her the next day I found that she was locked in a small, padded cell, presumably to protect her from herself and from others. Apparently, when assigned to a large room with other people, she wandered around as she had at our home.

I managed to get her released from that institution on condition that she would immediately fly back to Florida and begin treatment. Ben flew up to get her and took her back to Florida. I don't think she received any treatment in Florida; she was not eligible for Medicare, and I suspect they had no other health insurance that would cover mental conditions. So she just lived with it. She was about 56 years old.

Mother passed away at age 63 in December 1974 from liver cancer. So she was alive for seven years after the episode in Annapolis and four years after we purchased the house [at 81 Washington Street in Laconia, NH]. I think that my having



Ben Schreiber with Zaida's grave

purchased the house, relieving her of the financial and physical burden of taking care of it, and also providing her some cash, may have eased her mental challenges somewhat during the last few years of her life. I flew to FL to see her before her death when my step sister, Sharon, called to say that I needed to visit her soon if I wanted to see her alive.

Just before Christmas 1974 Mother died in Florida. Ben flew her body back to New Hampshire, had a funeral in the Episcopal Church she grew up attending, and buried her in Laconia next to her mother. She was back home and at peace.



The house at 81 Washington Street after Dick purchased it

My first life

Moving on to New Hampshire

Summers in Annapolis were hot and humid but we were on the Severn River and near Chesapeake Bay with cool water and cool breezes. It was not to be. The water was warm, it was brown in color, from soil erosion along the river banks, and there were jelly fish, lots of them. There were few breezes and they were warm, not cool; the sun was intense during the day. Becalmed out in the sailboat, or moving slowly under sail, I threw a line from the stern and jumped into the water, hanging onto the line. As the boat moved with me hanging on with one arm, jellyfish came down the line and up my arm. Warm, brown water, hot sun, little wind and jellyfish, get me out of here.

During my time at the Naval Academy, the only time I was in Annapolis in summer was my first year – Plebe Summer. We marched on the parade field in the hot sun, in uniforms, carrying a rifle. I remember it now but I guess I forgot when we decided to move to Annapolis. The other three years we were away, on Youngster Cruise to Brazil, Second Class summer in Little Creek, VA and Pensacola, FL, and First Class in the Mediterranean. It was nice in Annapolis in the spring and fall, and we had some wonderful sails. Karen and Scott were old enough to enjoy the sailboat.

Having spent my first eighteen years in New Hampshire, I was used to the sparkling clean water and fresh breezes of Lake Winnepesaukee in the summer. I didn't think much about the



Sailing on the Severn River and Chesapeake Bay

long, cold winters and late-arriving springs. I thought about the long commutes to DC from Annapolis. With my Naval Academy degree, having served as an Officer on Navy ships, a submarine and in Washington, I figured I could get a good job in NH. So we started to make plans to move back home to NH.

Since we especially enjoy warm weather we decided to move to NH at the beginning of summer. I notified my people at work and we contracted with a realtor to put our home in Annapolis on the market. Our next door neighbor, a Navy doctor, put his home, which was almost identical to ours, For Sale by Owner. His sold before ours and we ended up renting ours for a year or so. I'm kind of surprised that I used a realtor, after my experience buying our place. She estimated our closing costs at \$1800, and when we got to closing the costs were \$4800. I was really angry that she was so incompetent but I was fortunate that we had the money and were able to close the deal.

We planned to spend a month or more camping at our property in Deer Isle, ME. We had spent the first two weeks in August in Deer Isle since Scott was one year old. His birthday is on August 5 so we celebrated it in Deer Isle every year until he was 10. I had a couple of good leads on jobs, one in Nashua, NH and one in Saco, Maine. So we shipped our household goods to Portsmouth, NH, about midway between the two. I planned to spend the summer applying and interviewing for

jobs.



Some of Scott's birthdays in Deer Isle

When I resigned from government service in Washington, I had about $2\frac{1}{2}$ years of civilian service. After three years I could have taken a leave of absence and retained the three years for pay purposes if I ever went to work for the Federal Government again. I had no intention of working for the Federal Government so it didn't matter, I thought.

We got to Deer Isle in late June, set up our big, high wall tent and our cooking facility. We had the whole summer if we wanted it, not just two weeks in August. It was going to be wonderful! Some people believe that the Maine state bird is the mosquito. We believed it then; they just about carried us off. After a week we called it quits. The mosquitos won. We packed up and drove to NH, to Sue's parents' home. They invited us to stay with them until we got settled elsewhere. I sent out at least 75 resumes, mostly to companies in NH but also to a few in southern Maine. Nothing! In 1969 it seemed, nobody was interested in a Naval Academy grad with

at sea experience who worked on the submarine ballistic missile program in Washington. The two leads I had didn't work out either.



The high-wall tent and cooking facility in Deer Isle

Maybe I should have known. Once I hitch hiked from Annapolis to my home in NH to go on leave. I did great all the way to the NH border. There I stood all night; nobody would pick up a young man in uniform. In hindsight I should not have been hitch hiking in my Midshipman uniform, but I wanted to try it, a new adventure, and I thought at least a few people would give a service man a lift. I was partly right; everybody except those who live in NH. Finally, at around 4 AM, a man in a truck bringing morning newspapers to distribution centers picked me up and took me to an all-night diner where I called my parents to pick me up.

After a couple of months looking for a job, including checking with the civil service center in Portsmouth, NH about possible jobs at Portsmouth Naval Shipyard, I came up empty. In some desperation, I called my former associates

at the SSPO in Washington to ask who they knew that I might talk to at the Shipyard. A friend in SP 26 who worked closely with the shipyards gave me the name of a manager in a major department, and I made an appointment to talk to him. Finally, an appointment! Maybe something would work out after all.

Finding Work and a Place to Live in New Hampshire

The manager I got to talk to at Portsmouth Naval Shipyard told me that the shipyard spends \$100,000 per year recruiting engineers so they ought to take advantage when one walks in the door. He didn't have a position available in his department but he referred me to PERA(SS), another organization in the Shipyard. PERA(SS) stands for Planning & Engineering for Repairs and Alterations of Submarines. They had positions available in their planning & engineering and material support departments and offered me a job in whichever I preferred. I picked the Planning & Engineering Department and started work around the end of September.

I left Washington as a GS-13, step 2; they offered me a GS-12, step 5 which paid about the same the GS-13, step 2. Wow! I was back in NH making about the same as I had made in Washington. The cost of living was considerably lower in NH so, effectively, I was making more here than I had made in Washington. What a great way to start out. They say you can never go back home; I'm going to disprove that theory. One caveat, the Shipyard was under a closure order. It was scheduled to close in 1974, five years in the future, and they were under no obligation to me at that time. I was so happy to have a good job, I decided that I'd worry about that when the time comes. I would pump gas if that's what it took to stay in NH.

Next we went looking for a house to rent. I wanted a house with two garages, since we had two cars; with all the snow we get in NH it would be nice to keep both cars in a garage in the winter. So Sue and her father went looking for a house with two garages. I think they found one in Lebanon, ME but that was too far away. I wanted a shorter commute; that was one of the reasons we left Washington. They soon found one in Portsmouth, with two garages, not far from the Shipyard. That was great! I think it also had two bedrooms and a fireplace. It was a bit of a comedown from our home in Annapolis but we were back home in NH. Scott was 4 and Karen was 2, still



Dick's plaque from PERA(SS)

preschoolers.

We had sent our household goods to Portsmouth because it was midway between Nashua, NH and Saco, ME. How convenient was that now that we were going to live in Portsmouth? I think someone up there was watching over us. The Navy would even pay for shipping of household goods, but when I submitted my claim for moving expenses, my supervisor questioned why I sent our stuff to Portsmouth. I told him how it happened, a lucky coincidence. They did pay for the move.



Karen and Scott around this time

My Work in PERA(SS) and Portsmouth Naval Shipyard

I worked in the Planning & Engineering Department for a few months and then the Budget Officer decided to leave for another position. I had worked on budgets in SSPO, and I enjoyed and had a knack for working with numbers. It was a lateral move, another GS-12 position, but there was only one Budget Officer in our organization so I thought maybe I could distinguish myself. There were lots of engineers and I was one among many.

I applied for and was selected for the Budget Officer position. When it came time to put together a budget I didn't have a clue what to do. So I got with the Chief Engineer and he gave me some ideas on how to get started. The budget I ultimately put together was a big step forward as budgets go. I made sections corresponding to the various sources of funding, with rationale for all of the estimates. Then I made attractive covers of stiffer card stock and bound the whole thing with Cerlock bindings. People in PERA(SS) were impressed as were our customers at NavSea in Washington. That budget format was used for the entire time I was in PERA(SS), 16 years, and was still being used after I left.

A couple of years after I arrived at Portsmouth, the closure order was rescinded. It seems that President Nixon owed Senator Margaret Chase Smith of Maine a favor for something she had done for him. Payback was to lift the closure order, and he did it. Again, in 2005, the Base Realignment and Closure Commission placed the yard on a list of base closures, effective by 2008. Employees organized the Save Our Shipyard campaign to influence the committee to reverse its decision. On August 24, 2005, the base was taken off the list and continues operating under its motto, "From Sails to Atoms."

Established in 1800 during the administration of President John Adams, the Portsmouth Naval Shipyard is the oldest continuously-operating shipyard in the United States Navy. It began building warships with sails in the 1800s; during World War I, the shipyard began constructing submarines, the



Dick's plaque "Sails to Atoms"

first ever built by a U.S. Navy yard. After the war, the base continued to overhaul and repair surface vessels. The workforce grew to nearly 5,000 civilians. It grew to almost 25,000 civilians in World War II when over 70 submarines were constructed at the yard, with a record of 4 launched in a single day. When the war ended, the shipyard became the Navy's center for submarine design and development. In 1953, the Albacore would revolutionize submarine design around the world with its teardrop hull and round cross-section.

While Portsmouth Naval Shipyard dodged the closure bullet, there were other ways the Federal government reduced costs.



The Albacore submarine, on display in Portsmouth

RIFs (Reductions in Force) are used to reduce the numbers of employees. In RIFs certain positions are eliminated. Depending on the seniority of the person in the position being eliminated, he or she may be moved to another position that's not being eliminated and, if senior to the person in that position, may bump him or her to another position. That process continues until the least senior/most junior persons are pushed out the door. Until a person has three years of service, he or she is a probationary employee and is most susceptible to bumping. Having left Washington with 2 1/2 years of service I started my probationary service over again at Portsmouth. So, with less than 3 years of service, I got caught in the RIF.

I ended up in a GS-11 budget analyst position which was one of the positions I supervised. In actuality, I continued to do my Budget Officer job, but on paper I was a budget analyst. I was paid at the top of the GS-11 pay scale but that was less than my GS-12 pay; it was the best they could do under the rules. In a few months I was back in my job officially and making the

salary I had before the RIF. This was the cost of leaving civil service before I established tenure. While it was disappointing to be downgraded, I was fortunate that I didn't go out the door. I might have missed all that if I had stayed in my job in Washington until I had completed my probationary period. That's the price I paid for not planning further ahead and not considering the possibility of continued government service. We did get the summer off and it all worked out in the end.

One of the things I did as Budget Officer was to automate out financial reporting system. I worked with one of our systems analysts and together we designed and built a system that provided monthly financial reports that we needed to manage our funds. A few years after I left PERA(SS) I talked to the Chief Engineer and he told me that they had spent \$1M to upgrade the system and were not successful. I don't know what they ended up doing; maybe I could have become a consultant and helped to make the system work.

After a few years as Budget Officer I applied for and was selected for my boss's position, Administrative Officer and Head of the Logistics Division, a promotion to GS13. Now I was responsible for the Budget but also for Administrative and Secretarial Services, Quality Engineering and records. During this time I was selected to be on the SORT, Shipyard Operations Review Team. This was a team of senior people from all the Naval Shipyards, headed by Rear Admiral (Upper Half) Ted Young, a former Portsmouth Naval Shipyard Commander. Our mission was to review and analyze the operating procedures and processes at each Naval Shipyard, and recommend the best of them for adoption at all Naval Shipyards. I participated in the reviews of five Shipyards: Philadelphia, Mare Island, Charleston, Puget Sound and Pearl Harbor. When I left the team I was given a bronze plaque engraved with "Plank Owner," meaning one of the original members of the team. I have it proudly displayed on my "Vanity Wall," along with one for "fourteen years of outstanding service" from PERA(SS).

After working in the Naval Shipyards on SORT, I decided I would like to be Budget Officer of the shipyard. I was as high



Dick's "Plank Owner" plaque

as I could go in PERA(SS). The job became available, I applied and was selected. It was a lateral transfer at the GS13 level but it provided new challenges and new opportunities. I got my own parking space. I worked in the Comptroller Department. There was a position of Deputy Comptroller, GS14, but it was unfilled because the Comptroller, a Navy Captain, didn't think he needed a deputy. I was Budget Officer for a couple

of years and then the Captain retired; they reinstated the Deputy Comptroller position and I got it, largely based on my experience with SORT. After I left SORT, the team came to Portsmouth to review our procedures and processes. As a former member of SORT I was able to advise some of the senior managers on how to prepare for SORT and how to handle the interviews. I got points for that.

Around that time a classmate of mine from the Naval Academy, Captain Len Lammers, became Shipyard Commander. We had not known one another well but we knew we were classmates. Over nine hundred of us graduated in the Class of 1960. At this time shipyards were competing for submarine overhaul work based on competitive bids. The shipyard with the best price, quality and shortest duration of overhaul would receive the contract. Shipyard management decided it needed a Business Manager to head up the effort of putting together competitive bids. They attempted to attract a man from Electric Boat Co. who occupied a similar position there. He declined to come to Portsmouth but they still wanted a Business Manager. The Shipyard Commander decided his classmate could fill the bill. It was a GS14 position, same as the Deputy Comptroller. So I became the first Business Manager of a Naval Shipyard.

Fortunately I had good people working for me. We won the first four overhauls we bid on, "Four for Four." I began to feel as though I was in over my head. I was concerned that I had maybe reached my level of incompetence. Actually, in hindsight, I should have remained in the job until I reached retirement age of 55; I was 48. What I needed to do was get out of my comfort zone, work with my people and learn the details of how to put together a competitive bid.

Life in NH While Working at Portsmouth Naval Shipyard

We lived in Portsmouth for a year after I started working in PERA(SS). We socialized with my contemporaries who made us feel welcome, going out to dinner, to parties and other activities. We looked at houses in downtown Portsmouth, mostly old, historic houses. We scrounged wood from the area around the house, cut it up and split it for fire wood. We all enjoyed working with wood, knowing it would warm us several times before and after it was burned. We enjoyed having a fire in the fireplace on cold, snowy days and evenings.

We visited Sue's family frequently at their home in Weirs Beach and my father, less frequently, in Northfield, both about an hour and a half away. Sue's parents and three brothers all lived in the Lakes Region, and we had family dinners and outings together often on weekends. They were a close knit family that enjoyed being together, and I felt like part of the family. Our children were the only grandchildren in the Lindsey family at that time, so their grandparents especially enjoyed having them around.

My mother lived in Hialeah, FL with my stepfather, Ben Schreiber. She had use of the family homestead in Lakeport, also in the Lakes Region, as a result of my parent's divorce. She and Ben chose to live in FL rather than NH, and rented the

house as three apartments. Owning the house free and clear, no mortgage, and three tenants, it was costing her \$1,000 a year. It was being managed by a realtor, the son of a former friend of hers, who made it a money machine for himself by rotating tenants and other unscrupulous practices. The house was deteriorating. I felt that I needed to do something.

Sue and I discussed alternatives and decided to move to Lakeport for a year, kick out all the tenants, live in the house and fix it up. She would be close to her family and I could get the house squared away for my mother. It would be a long commute to the Shipyard, about an hour and a quarter, in all kinds of weather. I felt that I could do that for a year and then decide where to go from there. So much for not having to commute a long way to work, one of the reasons for leaving DC. That lasted for about a year while we lived in Portsmouth. But we were really back home; this was the house I grew up in.



Sue and Karen (inside) and Scott (outside) while living at 81 Washington Street

It had been ten years since I graduated from the Naval

Academy. Driving ships, going to school and working in an office can be rewarding but there was seldom a tangible product resulting from my efforts. Working on the house I could see the results and so could my family. I replaced broken windows, sanded hard wood floors as well as pine floors. I fixed plumbing and electrical problems. We had the exterior of the house painted. I removed partitions to make a new larger kitchen and a larger living room. I did this after getting home from work and on weekends. It was satisfying to see the progress.

My routine during the week was: get up at 5:30, have breakfast and leave the house by 6:15. I met up with three or four shipyard workers in Farmington, NH, about half way to Kittery. Then we car pooled to the Shipyard, getting to work by about 7:45 to start work at 8:00. We left the Shipyard about 4:45 and I arrived home around 6 PM. Sue made friends with other women in town and with mothers of children taking classes with Karen and Scott. She played tennis with Karen's teacher in the summer. She spent most of her time with the children when they were not in school.

We had dinner together as a family and I went to work on the house, quitting around 10 to go to bed. I took time out to rock Scott & Karen in the rocking chair and we sang songs like, "You are my sunshine," "I've been working on the railroad," "Daddy's little girl" and many others. Then they went to bed and I went back to work. We did the rocking chair/singing bedtime routine the whole time they were growing up.

Across the street from the house is Washington Street School, Grades K through 6. My father attended that school, I attended it and now my children were attending. It was a large, square structure with high ceilings and, directly inside the front door, a big stairway to the second floor. Whenever the children were outside, before entering school, they would line up by class on the walkway in front of the school and enter the school one class at a time. There were four rooms per floor, each occupying a quarter of the floor. Lower grades were on the first floor and upper grades on the second. Lavatories were in the basement along with the furnace, not a pleasant place to

visit.

My paternal grandmother was the janitor for this school and another, Mechanic Street School, on the other side of town, while my father was growing up. In winter she shoveled walkways, with my father's help, and stoked the furnace with coal to keep the schools warm. The teachers were mostly single women and my grandmother always had a party when one of them got married. She worked at that for many years, was retired for a few years and passed away in 1950 at the age of 75.



Susan Poole Davis's retirement notice

During our first winter in Lakeport we purchased a Ski Doo. It was a one cylinder, 12 HP snowmobile that was the most fun we ever had on the snow. It traveled through the snow like a boat in the water. It's an amazing feeling the first time you go down a hill of snow, bank and turn similar to a small boat.

What fun we had. Tom and Nancy, Sue's brother and sister-in-law, also purchased a Ski Doo and we sometimes went Ski Dooing together. Later, Sue's brother, Ted bought one.



Sue, Scott and Karen with Sue's brother Ted (right) and his wife Esther (center) on the Ski Doo

Our Ski Doo carried only two people so we also purchased a sled, configured like a dog sled, that we towed behind the snowmobile. Sue rode behind me on the snowmobile, Scott stood on the sled runners and Karen rode ahead of him, sitting in the sled. It was amazing where we could go, as a family, especially on Lake Winnepesaukee when it was frozen. Towing the sled was not practical on bumpy trails but we had a great time on frozen lakes. We usually ended up at somebody's house for dinner after an afternoon of snowmobiling. Life was good!



The family touring on the Ski Doo (composite of two images)

Red Camp

The story of the House in Lakeport and of my career at the Portsmouth Naval Shipyard got ahead of the story of our life in Lakeport. We moved there in 1970 and lived there as a family until 1978, nine mostly good years. We spent a lot of time with Sue's family, at their home at "Woodwinds" at Weirs Beach and at Red Camp.



Snowshoeing

"Red Camp" was a cottage we leased in the hills above

Plymouth. It was a joint effort by Sue's brothers, Tom and Ted and their wives, Nancy and Esther, Sue's parents, and us, each contributing 25% to the cost. We did this for several years. We used it in the winter for snowmobiling as well as snowshoeing and cross country skiing. From the tops of the mountains we had gorgeous views of the surrounding area covered in snow. In the summer we sub-leased "Red Camp" to a woman who worked with me in PERA(SS) and her husband. They enjoyed the solitude, the mountain air and the back to nature feel of the place in the summer.



Scott in the snow at Red Camp

"Red Camp" was unheated when we first saw it. Tom had a wood stove and stove pipe, which he contributed to the enterprise. We installed it in a central area, on a non-combustible surface, ran the stove pipe up from the stove, across the ceiling to a side window, out the window and then up to a point above the roof. It worked amazingly well; we got heat from the stovepipe as well as the stove. We brought a chain saw to cut firewood for the stove, dead wood when we

could find it. When we couldn't find dead wood we cut small, live birches; live birches have oil in their core and will burn green. So that's how we kept warm.



Scott and Dick spent a day building this lean-to at Red Camp, and slept in it for part of the night until they got too cold.

The kitchen had a cook stove, maybe fueled by propane. I don't remember, maybe because I didn't do much cooking. We had a white porcelain sink with no water; there was a well out back but it was frozen and not usable. The toilet facility consisted of an outhouse, located not far from the camp. It was unheated so people tended not to spend much time there.

We carried everything into the camp by snowmobile: food, drinks, water, sleeping bags, chain saw, whatever we needed for the weekend. The road to "Red Camp" was open in the summer but only plowed to within a mile or two of the camp in the winter. We brought the snowmobiles on trailers behind the cars, parked at the end of the road where the plowing ended, unloaded the snow machines and all our stuff, and carried it and the people to the camp. By then we had two snowmobiles, the



Snowmobiling into Red Camp

12 HP Ski Doo and a bigger 2 cylinder 25 HP machine I called the Big Pig. It was pinkish-red, heavy, got stuck often and was sometimes more work than fun, like a big pig. Sue drove the small machine with Karen on behind and I drove the bigger one with Scott. Scott got to drive the small machine on lakes and some of the easier trails.

We were all equipped with snowmobile suits, boots, gloves and helmets. The outfits kept us warm in the coldest weather. We were able to travel quite long distances from Red Camp, usually taking lunch to enjoy on the trail or at a nice spot near the trail. We had Bottom Bumpers patches on our suits. The “Bottom Bumpers” were the local snowmobile club. We joined because they groomed the snowmobile trails which made riding much smoother and more pleasurable.

Sue, Karen, Scott and I slept upstairs in the attic on mattresses on the floor. I think that was the only place that had room enough for four people. We had winter sleeping bags so we were warm and the mattresses were somewhat



Scott on the Big Pig



Dick and Sue in their snowmobile suits

comfortable during the night. One thing that was a little disconcerting was the mice that ran around in the attic, including over our sleeping bodies. They were little church mice and were not a hazard to our health; we were invading their space. I guess I was more tolerant of mice when I was younger.



Scott and Dick with the popup tent camper

We all still have fond memories of Red Camp, even 40 years after we were last there. It was a time of wonder, roughing it in a rustic cabin, taking off on trails through the woods, appreciating nature and being together as a family. Scott and Karen both have or have had tent campers as their children are growing up, and enjoyed sharing with their families some of the things we shared with them as they were growing up. These were times that were important to each of us and the memories are still quite vivid. It's nice when you can feel, "Hey, I did something good and right for the children which lives on and is being passed on to the next generation."



Scott's camper (top) and Karen's camper (bottom) in 2026

My second life

How Carol and I Met

It was January 1983, a Sunday night, and I was at the Singles Club dance at the VFW Hall in Rollinsford, NH with my former girlfriend, Joanne Bisson. Joanne loved to dance and we lived next door to one another in Kittery, ME, so we went to the singles dance together. We went with every intention of dancing with and meeting other people.

Joanne had been in one or more lesbian relationships but decided she'd like to try a straight guy. We did well for several months but then she decided she preferred the "alternative life style," as she called it. That was fine with me; Joanne was a good friend but I was happy to play the field; I had no intention of getting married again anyway.

It was, however, a little unsettling in that I had recently been divorced from my wife who was also lesbian as it turned out, or bisexual.¹⁰ I guess I was somehow attracted to gay women or they were attracted to me. Or, as was more likely, these women were attempting to determine if they could handle the straight life style, and I was somehow the Guinea pig. In both cases the answer was obviously no or, at least, I was not the answer.

One of the other people I met and danced with was Carol. I thought she was attractive and interesting, except that she mentioned early on how many graduate degrees she had; a Masters in Student Personnel and a MBA. That's a little much for me, having only a BS. I don't know if I can handle a woman

¹⁰When Dick and Sue got divorced, Sue and Carol Lucibello began a relationship that has continued for nearly 50 years as of this writing.

with more degrees than me. Joanne reminded me that she had a Master's in Education and that didn't seem to be a problem. Okay, I'll get her phone number and see what happens.

Carol gave me her phone number; I didn't write it down, I said I'd remember it. I suspect she figured, sure, he'll remember it, for two minutes if that long. That's a lost cause. So she was more than a little surprised when I called her that night after I got home from the dance. Back then, some 32 years ago, memorizing things was easy; my mind was still relatively uncluttered and I thought back to Plebe year at the Naval Academy when I memorized fifteen or twenty verses of "The Laws of the Navy."

On the phone I asked if she'd like to go out to dinner sometime, and she answered yes. So a few days later we went to a nice restaurant in Portsmouth where she had taken her favorite aunt and uncle recently and had a lovely meal. They seated us in a booth in a room off the main dining area; there was another couple in a booth across the aisle. Not long after we sat down the man across the aisle became very sick. Out of his mouth came a stream of sickly liquid like out of a hose. And it kept coming.

That kind of put a damper on the evening so I invited her to see my home in Kittery. It was a little Cape Cod style house that I was fixing up. The walls were down to bare plaster, I don't remember exactly what state the rest of the house was in but it was definitely a work in progress. I think she had expected something a little more elegant. In any case, that was the first date. For most people that probably would have been the last date. But she saw some hope behind the rough exterior, I guess. She liked the idea of a guy who can fix stuff. Like her father, I have a pretty good mechanical mind, I know how to use tools and I can fix stuff. At least I could back then. Recently I decided I have fixed enough stuff and we can hire it done by someone else from now on.

We had subsequent dates that first winter. We went cross country skiing along the Piscataquis River in Kittery. She invited me for dinner at her place and I brought a loaf of whole



Carol and her mother at the Kittery house under renovation

wheat quick bread that I had baked. That made a few points. I asked her if she was into whole foods and she mentioned chocolate. I have come to believe that chocolate, especially dark chocolate, is a pretty good food, maybe not whole food but good nonetheless.

We dated for another year and a half. I was still not interested in marriage. On Valentine's Day, 1984, Carol thought I might propose to her. It never entered my mind. During that time we camped in Deer Isle and began building the cabin. In late summer when the cabin was enclosed, the shell was complete, I finally decided that maybe it was time to test the water and I asked her if she would like to get married. She answered yes and set a date for the wedding on October 6. No long engagement here. She was 39 and wanted children so there was no time to waste. The clock was ticking.

I took Karen and Scott, ages 17 and 19, out to dinner and told them that Carol and I were getting married. I also told them that we planned to have a baby and to try not to think



Carol and Dick at their wedding on October 6, 1984

the old man had gone completely out of his mind. I was only 46 at the time. They were okay with it and stood up with me at the wedding, as my best man and best woman. So, we went from meeting at the singles club to married in a mere 21 months. Not bad for a guy who wasn't interested in marriage and a gal whose clock was ticking. We finally got it together and it just keeps on getting better.

Retired at Age 48

I took the oath of office as a midshipman at the Naval Academy June 8, 1956. I spent four years at the Naval Academy, six and a half years on active duty in the Navy and nineteen and a half years working as a civilian for the Navy. In 1986 I had thirty years of government service and was eligible to retire. Carol and I had been married for two years and our daughter, Diana, was one.

It was my intent to work in the private sector and do something different from what I had been involved with for the last thirty years, namely, the Navy. I had an idea that I could buy distressed real estate, fix it up as needed, and sell it for a profit. I would obtain listings of foreclosed property, visit the owner and offer to purchase the property. People who have been foreclosed upon are not friendly to someone who wants to take their property. So it was not fun to knock on their door and attempt to talk to them about their home. Maybe if I had worked through a bank or mortgage company I would have been more successful.

Since I was interested in real estate I decided to try selling residential real estate. I took the course, passed the test and got a position with a local real estate firm, Dan Gabriel Real Estate in Dover. I went to a conference of new real estate sales people and we were told that fifty percent of us would not be selling real estate a year from that time. They weren't talking about me! I was going to be making lots of money and driving around in a big car in the near future. That was before I learned that,

in real estate, ten percent of the people make ninety percent of the money, and ninety percent of the people make ten percent of the money. I turned out to be one of the ninety percent that make ten percent of the money. The way to make money in real estate is to get listings, get people to list their homes with you. Most people want to list their homes with successful realtors. You also need to do a lot of cold calling, calling people you don't know from telephone listings out of the phone book. The yield rate from cold calling is between 1 and 5 percent. You need to be able to put up with a lot of rejection. It was not fun.

A New Baby at Age 47

When Diana was born in 1985 I was 47 and Carol was 40; I wrote in her Baby Book about some of the advantages and disadvantages of having older parents. I mentioned that Mommy and I were settled in our jobs and in our home, were making good salaries and were not spending extra time and effort to move up the corporate ladder. We could spend more quality time with her and less time at work or working on the house and other activities as I, at least, had done the first time around. The disadvantage was that we were older than the parents of most of her friends, although that should not be a big deal at least until we get a lot older.

Diana is now 31, I am 78 and Carol is 71; I want to take a look at how things worked out and what are the good and not so good things that happened or may happen in the future, at least partly because of our more advanced ages. While Diana was growing up we had the opportunity to go on at least 8 Family Hostel trips to Europe and Central America. That was possible because Carol was the UNH Rep on these trips and I was retired from the Shipyard and able to go and to assist. I retired when she was 1 year old so while I kept working at other things my time was very flexible. Not many students from age 8 were able to travel to the Continent and Costa Rica each summer. In Costa Rica she met her best friend of many years and they are still in touch.

Another advantage was that we valued education and were able to help her go to Phillips Exeter Academy for high school



Dick, Carol, Diana, and Leona Bischoff (Carol's mother) on a Familyhostel trip to Paris in 1993

and to Williams College for her undergraduate work. Carol had set aside money for college which we ended up using for PEA. We and Grandma Bischoff also came up with the money for Williams, for which Diana received no financial aid. In my first life, we had set aside no money for the children's college but Scott was able to attend Tufts University on a NROTC scholarship which I helped him get, and Karen went to UNH on half tuition because Carol was employed there. We helped with other expenses but expected them to work in the summer and pay some of their college expenses. Diana did not work in the summer¹¹ and did not contribute to her college expenses. She did travel to France for six weeks during one summer and to Japan during another summer which were probably more valuable than working a summer job.

Diana always did well academically and was able to attend

¹¹Diana *did* work in the summer: during high school, at Goose Cove Lodge and at Haystack; during college, at UNH, PEA, Williams, and NMH.

the educational institutions of her choice. For her PhD she chose to study math at Brown University. She was able to get a full scholarship for five years of study, covering not only tuition but also including a stipend for living expenses. She did that completely on her own and even saved some money along the way. We loaned her our car, a used 2001 Honda Accord, which she drove until the transmission began to have problems in fall 2016 when she was working at Williams.

Before Diana was born, Carol and I built a cabin on the ocean in Maine. While she was a toddler I installed plumbing and electricity in the cabin, and she played on a carpet in the crawl space under the cabin while I worked there. She may have acquired some appreciation and feel for what it takes to do that kind of work. Carol talked to her extensively and Diana was able to speak in full sentences early on. We both read to her and she had a good vocabulary at an early age.

She taught at Brown and PEA during summers and made money at that. She had a boyfriend, Alan B, for her last 4 years at Brown but broke up with him just before graduation. In her thesis she thanked Alan for his help and support along the way; she thanked Carol and me also.

After Brown Diana did a 3 year Post Doc at Northwestern in Evanston, IL. She taught math to undergraduates, did research and published articles on her research, often collaborating with other mathematicians at Northwestern and abroad. She attended several math conferences both in the US and overseas.

In her last year at Northwestern she applied to 100 colleges and universities for a position on the math faculty. She received three offers of tenure track positions¹² but ultimately declined all of them for a temporary assistant professorship at Williams where she got her undergraduate degree. She is currently teaching two higher math courses there and enjoying both the work and the place. She will apply for a permanent position there and at many other colleges starting soon.

¹²Siena College, Gonzaga University, U.S. Naval Academy

We are proud of her and all she has accomplished. We like to think that some of what she accomplished was due in part to some of the opportunities we made possible for her, many of which we could not have done without the resources we acquired before she came along.

So, I covered what I perceive as some of the advantages of having older parents; I didn't discuss any disadvantages. From our perspective (and hers) we won't get to share the last few decades of her life, although, having seen the first three and maybe a couple more, we can picture what the future may hold for her. We cannot guess who she may end up with for a life partner. We don't know if we'll be blessed with a grandchild or grandchildren in the next few years. We can guess that she will continue teaching at the college level, do research and continue to excel at that. We hope that she will inherit the property in Maine, and use it, share it and enjoy it as we have.

In the last year or so she has begun to show her appreciation to us for some of the things we do and have done for her. She has begun to realize that our time and that of all of us is finite and will end at some point. She has made a special effort to foster a close relationship with her half siblings and her nieces and nephews. She has made it possible for them to attend a 5 week summer session at PEA because they probably won't get the opportunity to go there for high school as she did. We can take pride in what we have all done to date.

Being a New Father at Age 27 and 47

Was I a better father the second time around?

After about two and a half years in Washington as a Naval Officer I was able to convert the job to civil service, resign from the Navy, convert myself to civilian employee and stay in the same job. At about that time we decided to buy a home and move to Annapolis. We bought a Dutch Colonial home at 108 Melvin Avenue in West Annapolis. On some weekends we went camping. We helped found and went camping with the “Annomads.” Scott and I went with the group to Gettysburg for a weekend soon after Karen was born; she was too young to go camping. Our favorite family camping places in Maryland were Ocean City, and Point Lookout, where the Chesapeake Bay and Potomac River meet.

Other times we went sailing on the Severn River and Chesapeake Bay. One of the major reasons for moving to Annapolis was to sail. We bought a wooden 27’ Alden sloop which required work. Working on the boat one day, Scott was in the forward hatch, got his hands into pentachlorophenol, a preservative, and rubbed his eyes. He remembers that still. But we had some good times sailing the boat, and got compliments on its appearance.

After about three years in Annapolis we decided to move back to New Hampshire. Commuting to Washington from Annapolis had become a burden and sailing in the Severn River



Dick and Scott camping when Scott was young



Scott working on the 27' Alden sloop

and Chesapeake Bay was not nearly as nice as I had expected. So, in June, 1969, we moved back home. We moved in with Sue's family while I looked for a job; we all enjoyed being in NH with the Lindseys, near Lake Winnepesaukee for the summer. After a fruitless job search, finally in September I used my contacts in DC and got an interview and ended up with a great position at Portsmouth Naval Shipyard. We moved to Portsmouth and rented a home close to the Shipyard. After a year, in 1970, we decided to move to Lakeport, purchase and refurbish my family home. Scott was five and started Kindergarten at Washington Street School, across the street from our home. My father and I both attended Washington Street School. It is now a condominium, replaced by Elm Street Elementary School, about a half mile away.

During Scott and Karen's early years I was commuting to Portsmouth and back each day, leaving before they got up, returning at dinner time and working on the house at night. I always rocked and sang to them before they went to bed and before I started working on the house. Neither Sue nor I were readers at the time so we didn't emphasize reading. They were intelligent and did well in school. Scott mentioned recently how amazed he is that I was able to be Scoutmaster of the Lakeport Boy Scout Troup 147 after commuting to Portsmouth and back. We did campouts on the weekend as well.

After the divorce I made an effort to see Scott and Karen both in Lakeport and in Kittery where I was living. I attended some of Scott's cross country meets and Karen's field hockey meets. At one of Scott's cross country meets at Opeechee Park, I mentioned to him a statement made by Lee Trevino, a professional golfer, "You cannot win unless you tell yourself and know in your heart that you can win." I think he won that day. He was the first record holder on the Opeechee Park course after it was first established.

I took Scott to college night at Laconia High and introduced him to the NROTC representative; he ultimately received a full four year scholarship to Tufts University, compliments of the Navy. One summer Scott and Karen spent part of their vacation



Dick, Scott, and Jimmy Lucibello (Carol's son, Scott's stepbrother) in the Boy Scouts

working on my house in Kittery, staining shingles, nailing them on the house and residing my garage apartment with fiberglass siding. So we stayed in touch pretty well. Karen attended UNH and, as Carol's step-daughter, received reduced tuition. We helped both Scott and Karen with college costs such that they had no college loans after graduation. We didn't have as close and loving a relationship as with Diana, and we still don't, but they turned out well anyway.

After I retired from the shipyard, I decided to build an addition to Carol's house: an in-law apartment, south facing glass for passive solar heat, super insulation for efficiency and a garage underneath. Actually I didn't build the structure, I just completed the interior and exterior, including plumbing and electrical work. Diana was able to play on the floor as I installed plumbing, wiring and sheetrock on the ceiling and walls. After we had the cabin built in Deer Isle I needed to



Scott and Dick prepare for a trip in the White Mountains



Karen working on the Kittery house

plumb and electrify that also. Diana played on a rug in the crawl space beneath the cabin while I soldered the water lines and did the wiring. She played in her crib near the ocean when we turned the Flying Scot sailboat on its side at high tide to paint the bottom. I included her in many of my activities, some of which involved building things. She has inherited or acquired the ability and skill to make things of wood using hand tools and machines in Maine. I rocked and sang her to sleep as I had done with Scott and Karen. Both Carol and I read books to Diana, some of which my father provided.



The Flying Scot sailboat

Carol was experiencing her first and only child and she made the most of it. Being quite verbal herself, she talked extensively to Diana. Diana was talking and reading ahead of her age group

from the beginning. I understood that a girl or young woman's ability to relate to boys or young men can depend somewhat on the relationship she has with her father. So I did my best to have a close, loving relationship with Diana. I think I succeeded pretty well; we still have a close, loving relationship, I think.

We were initially taken aback when Diana came out as lesbian. While we were surprised it is not something people choose, it's the way they are. So it is no reflection one way or the other on us or anyone else. As Pete Buttigieg has said, don't talk to me, talk to my maker.



Carol, Diana, and Dick after Diana's 6th grade cross country meet in 1996

So, I feel as though I did pretty well as a father in both instances. I regret that I was absent from their home during

both Scott and Karen's adolescence. I think I was enough of a presence for Scott that he got through adolescence knowing something of what it takes to be a man. Sue was a good mother to both of them and they felt secure. They were able to grow up in their own home. It was surely more fun for me the second time around not having to give a lot of emphasis to my job. I was able to really enjoy, appreciate and be present for all of Diana's occasions, large and small.

Do I ever think about what might have been had my first marriage endured?

Not much. I regret that I was not present for Scott and Karen's high school years. But I was there for them most of the time when they needed me. Sue has had a good life with her partner of 30 plus years; she's happier than she would have been with me. For all that I lost or missed out on with Scott and Karen, I surely received more than I could possibly have hoped for or imagined with Carol and Diana. Regrets, I've had a few but overall things have turned out really well. I hope these golden years continue as long as we do. It has been a good ride.



A boat ride with Dick, Carol, Leona, Diana, and Dick's Aunt Marguerite c. 1995

Again, I think that someone up there was looking out for me. After the failure of my first marriage I was blessed with Carol and Diana. This would not have happened if my first marriage had endured. So, in spite of having screwed up the first time around, I had a second chance at happiness. I was lucky to find Carol who was able to live with my selfishness and other challenging qualities, always trying to teach me to do better. It has been a hard grind but we have made enough progress to commit for the duration. It's definitely too hard to contemplate starting over with someone else.



Christmas 2021 with Scott and Diana and their families: Ethan, Karen, Scott, and Carlee (Scott's son, wife, self, and daughter), Diana, Margo (Diana's wife), Carol and Dick in Bow, NH at Scott's house

The Richard B. Davis Revocable Trust of 1999.

The trust was set up to minimize federal estate taxes at the time of my death. Carol and I split all of our assets at the time the trust was written, placing her assets in her trust and my assets in mine. Most of my assets are owned by the trust, including the house and land in Deer Isle, ME, and funds in a Vanguard trust account. Life insurance policies and my IRA have specified beneficiaries. While the tax-exempt amounts have increased to the point that the trust may not be needed for tax purposes, it nonetheless distributes assets as I desire. A copy of the trust can be found in the fireproof box in the walk-in closet in the bedroom of the new house in Deer Isle.

House and land in Deer Isle, ME. This includes approximately 400 feet of waterfront on Southeast Harbor, four acres of land and a house of approximately 3000 square feet. Estimated value is about \$600,000. Taxes are currently about \$3,500 per year and insurance is about \$1500.

My goals with respect to the house and land in Deer Isle, ME.

If I predecease Carol, I want the property to be available for her use as long as she is able to use and enjoy it. During this time I want the property also available for use by my children on a fair and equitable basis. My wish is that Carol has unrestricted use of the whole property when none of the children are in residence. The legal mechanism is that she will manage my

trust and exercise ownership type authority and responsibility over the property until her death or incapacity.

When one or more children is/are in residence, then Carol will have use of the original cabin and office, the children will have use of the newer addition/house, and everybody will share use of the breezeway and the remainder of the property. The users must clean and be responsible for what they use.

I'd like to see the property stay in the family forever. This may be an unrealistic goal since I cannot predict what the next ten years will bring, nor the next twenty nor the next fifty. I'd like to pass it on to my children and grandchildren. This has been a formula for disaster in several nearby properties. It not only doesn't work, it also tears the family apart. So I have decided, in consultation with my children, that the property should be sold as further specified below.

It is a valuable property on the Coast of Maine, truly exquisite and beautiful. It is unaffordable for the average person to purchase now and is becoming less affordable each year. It needs to be lived in, loved and maintained as we have done over the past fifty years or so. If it is not used and enjoyed, it can quickly deteriorate and becomes a burden. Because of that possibility, it will be sold at the time of my death or Carol's, whichever occurs last.

The problem with selling the property and splitting the proceeds is that once the property is gone, it is gone forever. So I stipulate that the proceeds from a sale be placed in a trust and invested for each family with directions that it be used for education, health care, retirement or a recognized charity. Each non-purchasing family could potentially receive \$200,000, more or less, in a trust, which will grow exponentially over time through compounding interest. If used sparingly, the trust could pass from generation to generation.

At such time as Carol and I, or the survivor of the two of us, is no longer able to use nor willing to be responsible for the property, or at my death or Carol's, whichever occurs last, each of my children will be asked the following questions:

- Do you want to buy the property?
- Can you pay for it?
- Is there a scenario in which one of your siblings can buy it?

In any case the property will be appraised by three qualified property appraisers for fair market value, a selling price will be established based on that value and the property will be offered for sale. If one child wants to buy the property, can pay for it and the other siblings agree, then he/she can buy the property and pay each of his/her siblings one third of the selling price. For example, if the assessed value is \$600,000, the purchasing sibling would pay each of his or her siblings \$200,000 and assume title to the property.

I'm hesitant to have ownership shared. And I am not open to dividing and selling a portion of the property, nor having one of my children own part of the property and another own the other part. Any of these options would degrade the value of the homestead, possibly lead to disagreements and strain family relationships. I do hope most fervently that if one member of the family acquires the property, he/she will share the use of it generously with his/her siblings and their families.

If one of my children predeceases me, then at my death his/her children will inherit his/her share of the proceeds in a trust. If one of my children predeceases me and has no living children, then at my death his/her share of the proceeds of my trust shall go into a trust set up by that child as he/she may desire. All trusts and other monies emanating from my property or my trust shall be used specifically for education, health care, retirement or a recognized charity.

Though unlikely unless circumstances change substantially, in the event that Carol or I cannot maintain a reasonable lifestyle without tapping the value of the Deer Isle property, possibly as a result of a catastrophic illness or injury, then we may sell the property and retain the proceeds to maintain a reasonable lifestyle. In this event, each of my children will be

asked the questions above and, if one child wants to buy the property, can pay an agreed upon price for it and the other siblings agree, then he/she will have first right of refusal on the property.